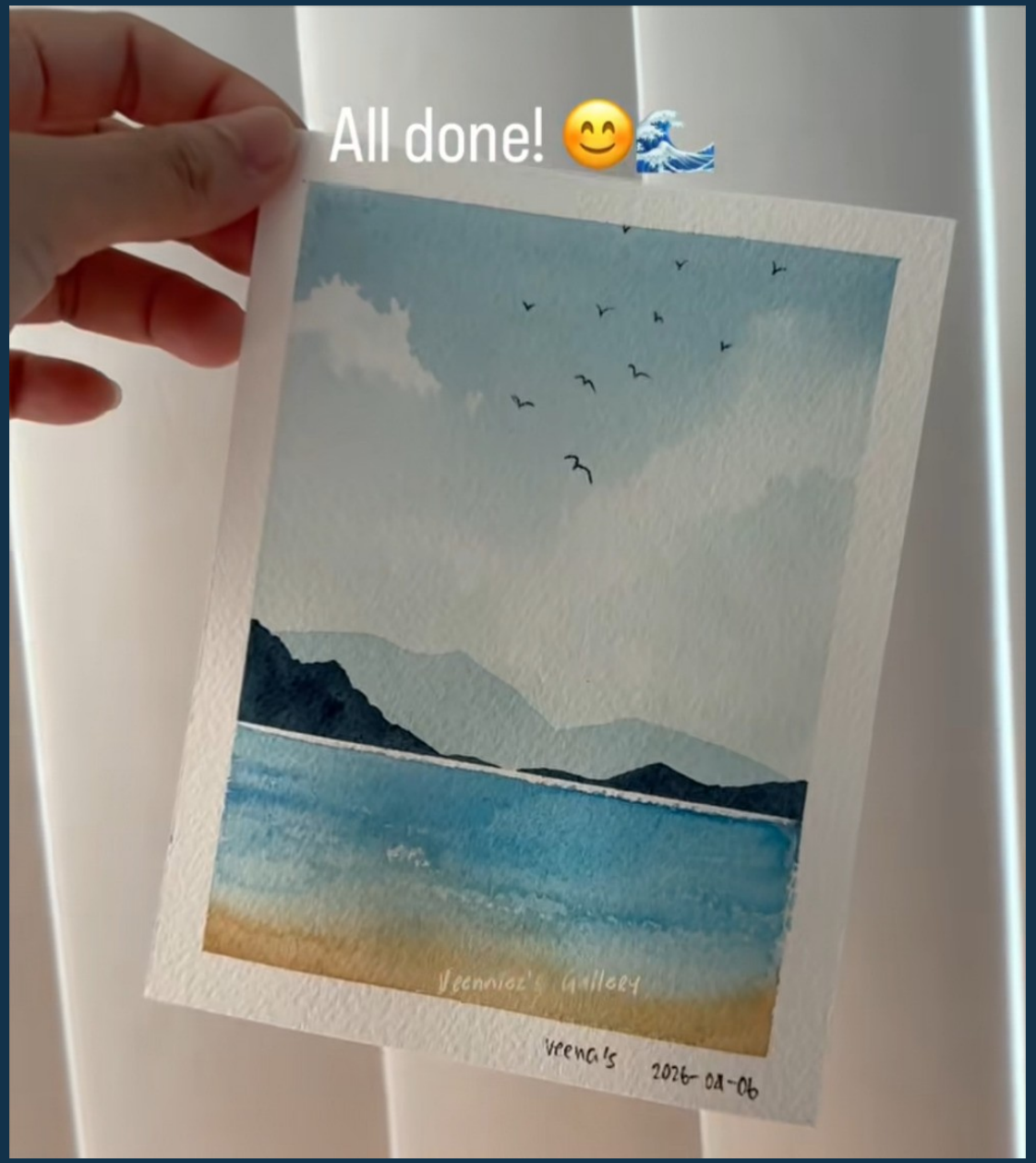
Watercolor Seascape

A step-by-step guide for beginners: sky, mountains, sea and beach in loose, layered washes



60 steps from wet paper to finished painting

Built from screenshots of a Facebook reel by Veenniez's Gallery (“3-minute seascape process”). Colors are kept as they appear in the reel.

What you will paint



1

Light to dark, far to near

The pale sky and far mountains go in first. The darkest shapes (the near mountains) come next, then the sea and sand.

2

Let each layer dry

The artist starts wet-on-wet, then twice writes “Let it dry..” before adding the next layer. Waiting keeps edges crisp.

3

Save the whites

Clouds are lifted out with a tissue, waves are flecks of unpainted paper, and a thin white line marks the horizon.

The artist's on-screen captions stay visible in every frame, and the step titles in this guide follow them.

The painting in eleven stages



1. Wet the paper

Steps 1–2

A wet-on-wet start



2. Sky

Steps 3–6

Prussian blue, deep to pale



3. Clouds

Steps 7–17

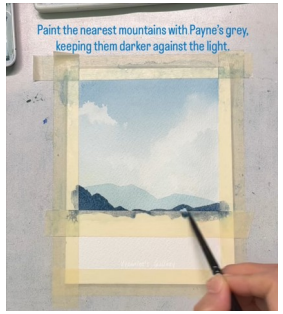
Lift with tissue, add shadows, dry



4. Far mountains

Steps 18–23

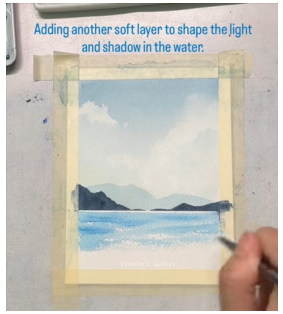
Pale, diluted blue



5. Near mountains

Steps 24–27

Dark Payne's grey



6. Sea

Steps 28–33

Phthalo blue with light wave flecks



7. Beach

Steps 34–40

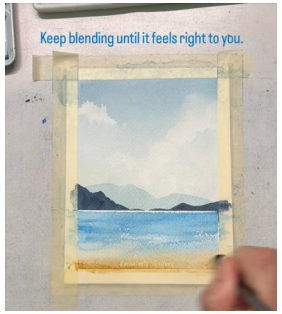
A soft raw sienna wash



8. Deepen the color

Steps 41–47

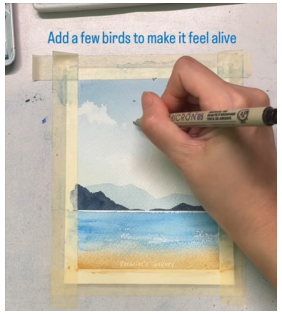
An optional extra layer



9. Blend

Steps 48–50

Soften until it feels right



10. Birds

Steps 51–57

Tiny birds in black ink



11. Finished painting

Steps 58–60

Reveal and compare

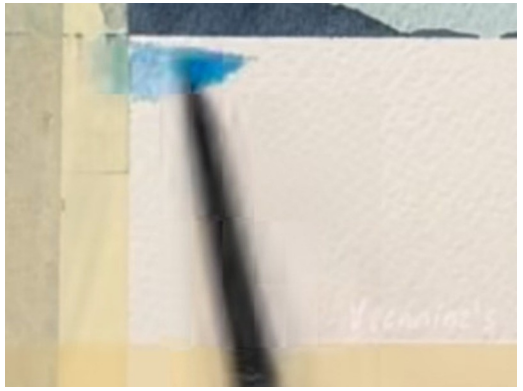
Tools and materials seen in the reel



Masking tape

Steps 1–27

Taped on all four sides, plus a strip across the lower paper that masks the sea area until the mountains are done.



Round brush, black handle

Most paint steps

A small round brush for the mountains, sea and beach. Sizes are not stated.



Tissue

Steps 7–13

A crumpled tissue pressed onto the wet blue lifts paint and leaves soft cloud shapes.



Fine black pen

Steps 51–57

A fine-tip pen labeled Micron 05 draws the birds in black ink.

Also visible: watercolor paper with a visible grain (the texture that makes light brushing leave tiny white flecks), a small palette of paint, and a work surface. The artist names four pigments in the captions: Prussian blue, Payne's grey, phthalo blue and raw sienna.

Your color palette



Prussian blue

Named in the artist's captions

#5E95AE · Steps 3–16

Sky wash, cloud shadows



Prussian blue, diluted

Named in the artist's captions

#BFCBC7 · Steps 18–22

Pale background mountains



Payne's grey

Named in the artist's captions

#344556 · Steps 24–27, 46

Dark near mountains



Phthalo blue

Named in the artist's captions

#67A6CC · Steps 28–33, 38, 41–50

The sea



Raw sienna

Named in the artist's captions

#D7B47C · Steps 34–41, 47, 49–50

The beach



Black fine-tip pen

Not a paint

#314343 · Steps 51–57

The birds (ink, not paint)

Paper white

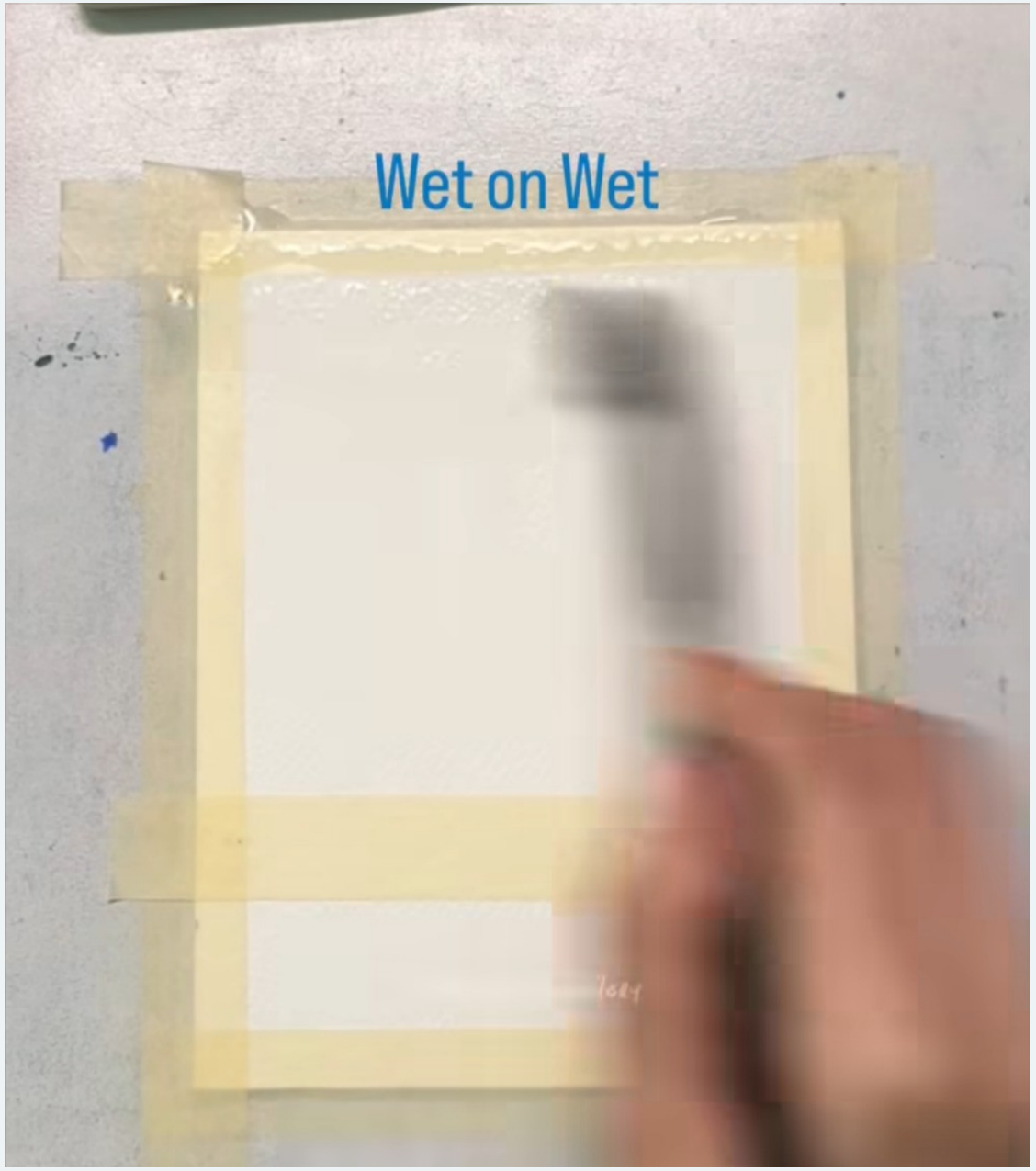
Not a paint

#DEDED6 · Unpainted paper

Clouds, wave flecks, horizon line

How to read these

Hex values were sampled from the screenshots, so they will look a little different on your screen and paper. Use them to match by eye, and test on scrap paper first.



STAGE 1 · WET THE PAPER

Wet the whole painting area first

WHAT TO DO

- Tape the paper flat on all four sides. In the reel it is already taped down.
- With a large, soft brush, spread clean water evenly over the area you will paint.

WATCH FOR

The caption is “Wet on Wet”: color will spread softly only where the paper is damp.

NO PAINT YET: CLEAN WATER ONLY



STAGE 1 · WET THE PAPER

Brush out puddles for an even sheen

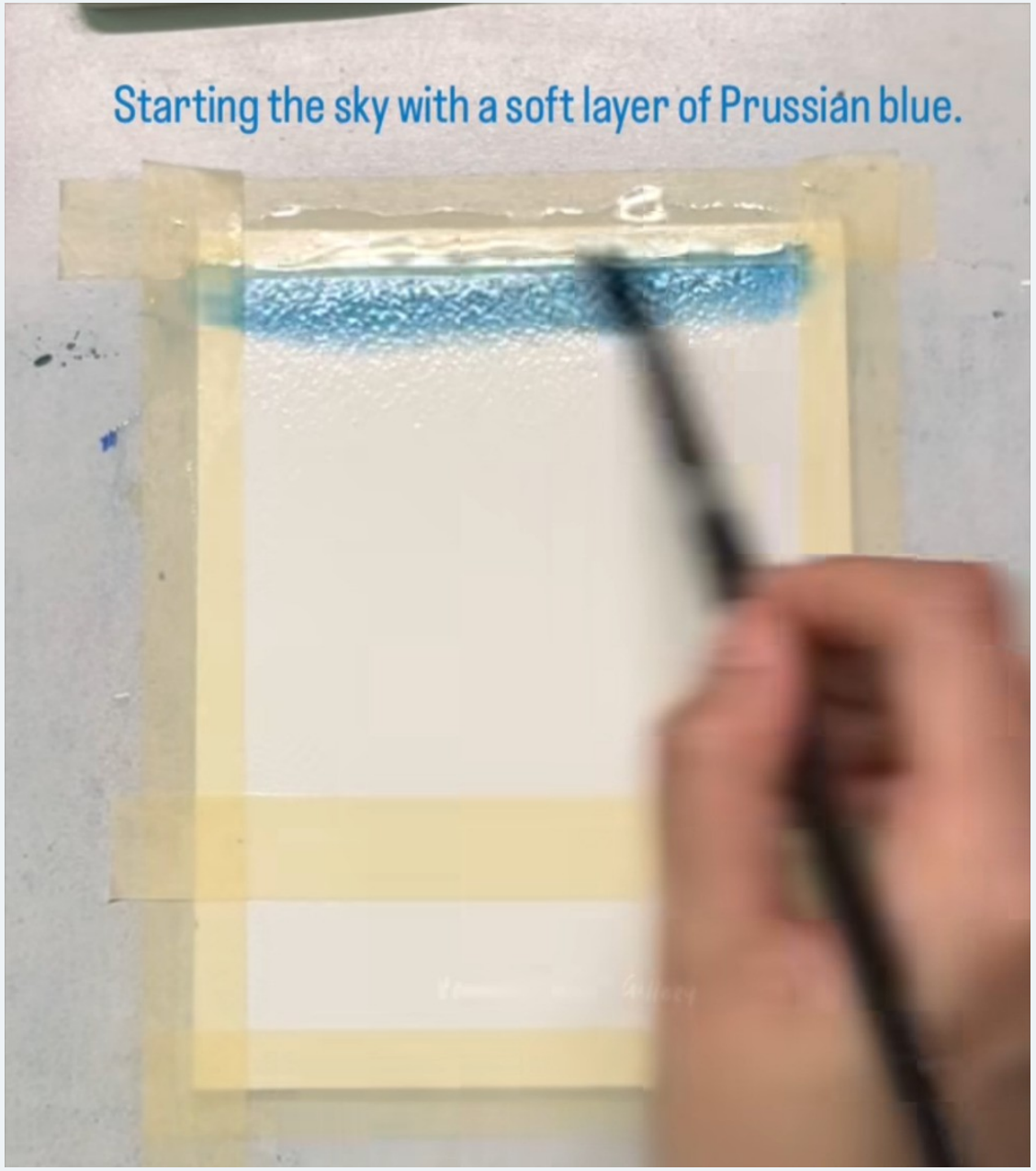
WHAT TO DO

- Keep brushing until the whole area looks glossy and evenly damp.
- Smooth out any puddles so water is not pooling in one spot.

WATCH FOR

Damp and shiny is right. Running water means too wet; a dull surface means it is drying.

NO PAINT YET: CLEAN WATER ONLY



STAGE 2 · SKY

STEP 3 OF 60

First stripe of Prussian blue

WHAT TO DO

- Load a brush with Prussian blue mixed with plenty of water.
- Lay one stripe along the top edge of the wet paper and let it start to spread.

WATCH FOR

Start at the very top. The sky should be deepest there and fade as it comes down.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Prussian blue
#5E95AE



STAGE 2 · SKY

Pull the blue down the page

WHAT TO DO

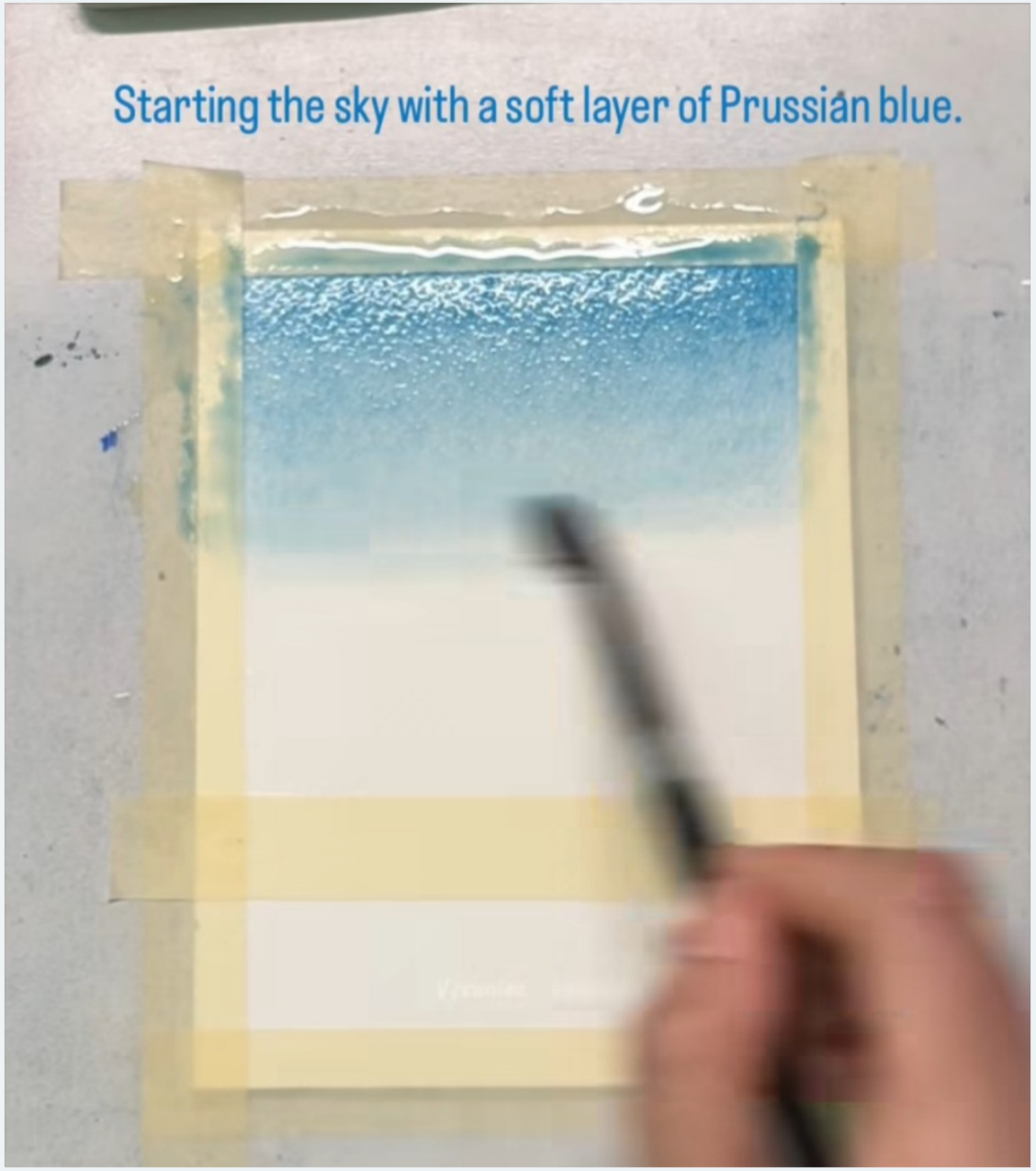
- Drag the color downward with broad, loose strokes.
- Let the wet paper carry the blue; it softens by itself.

WATCH FOR

Don't scrub. A few confident strokes keep the wash smooth.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Prussian blue
#5E95AE



STAGE 2 · SKY

STEP 5 OF 60

Fade the blue toward the middle

WHAT TO DO

- Add a little more blue near the top, then use a lightly loaded brush to pull it down.
- Let the color thin out into the white of the paper.

WATCH FOR

The lower half of the sky stays very pale, which leaves room for clouds.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Prussian blue
#5E95AE



STAGE 2 · SKY

Smooth the transition

WHAT TO DO

- Soften the lower edge of the blue so there is no hard line.
- Stop while the paper is still damp, because the next step lifts wet paint.

WATCH FOR

Don't wait for the sky to dry yet. The tissue only lifts paint that is still wet.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Prussian blue
#5E95AE



STAGE 3 · CLOUDS

STEP 7 OF 60

Dab the first cloud with a tissue

WHAT TO DO

- Crumple a clean tissue and press it onto the wet blue, starting at the right edge.
- Lift straight up. The tissue removes paint and leaves a soft, pale cloud shape.

WATCH FOR

Press and lift. Rubbing would smear the color instead of lifting it.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Prussian blue
#5E95AE



STAGE 3 · CLOUDS

STEP 8 OF 60

Keep lifting paint along the right side

WHAT TO DO

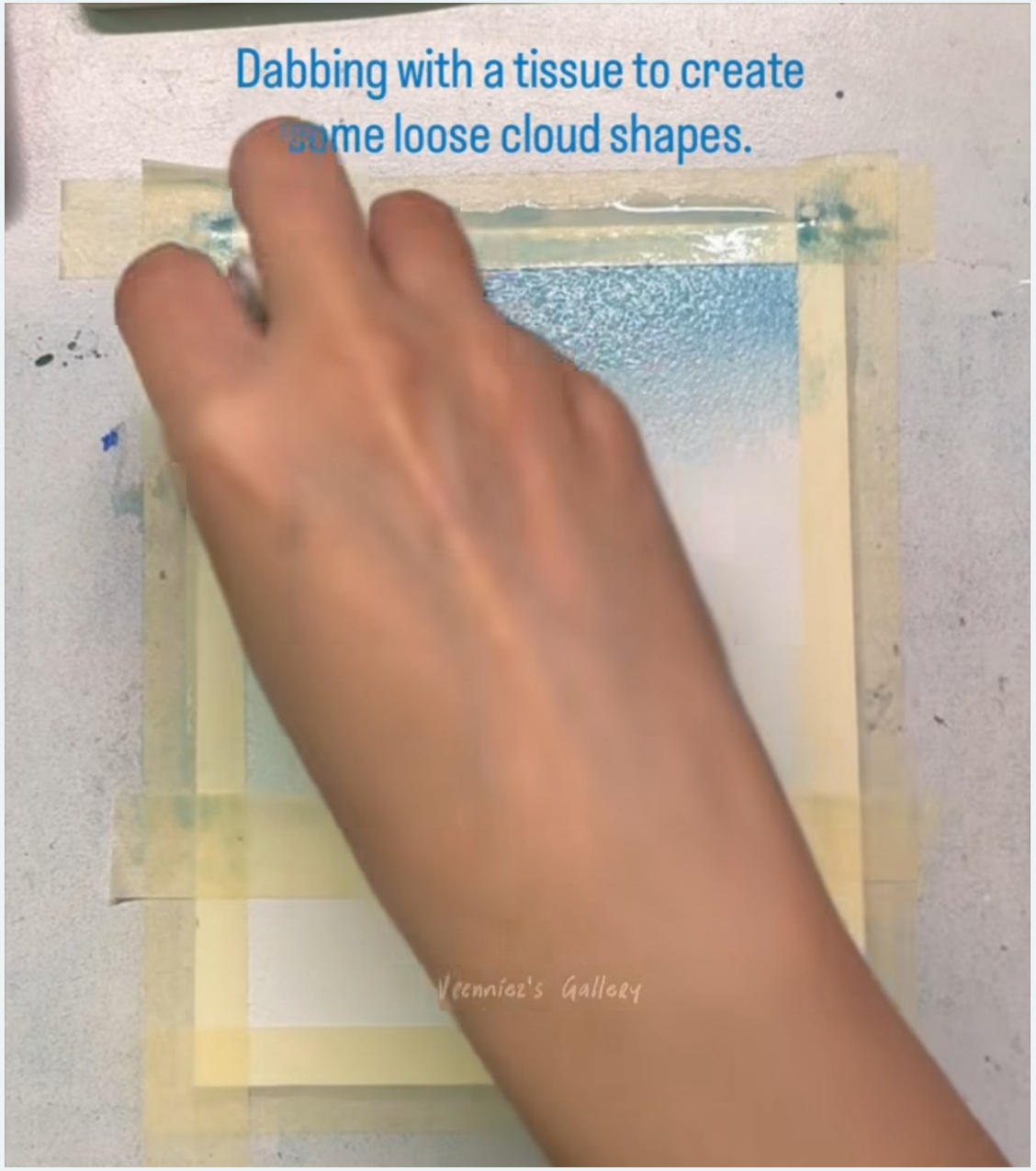
- Dab the tissue in several spots along the edge of the sky.
- Vary the size and spacing of the dabs so the clouds look natural.

WATCH FOR

Clouds are loose shapes with soft edges, not outlines.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Prussian blue
#5E95AE



STAGE 3 · CLOUDS

STEP 9 OF 60

Dab across the middle of the sky

WHAT TO DO

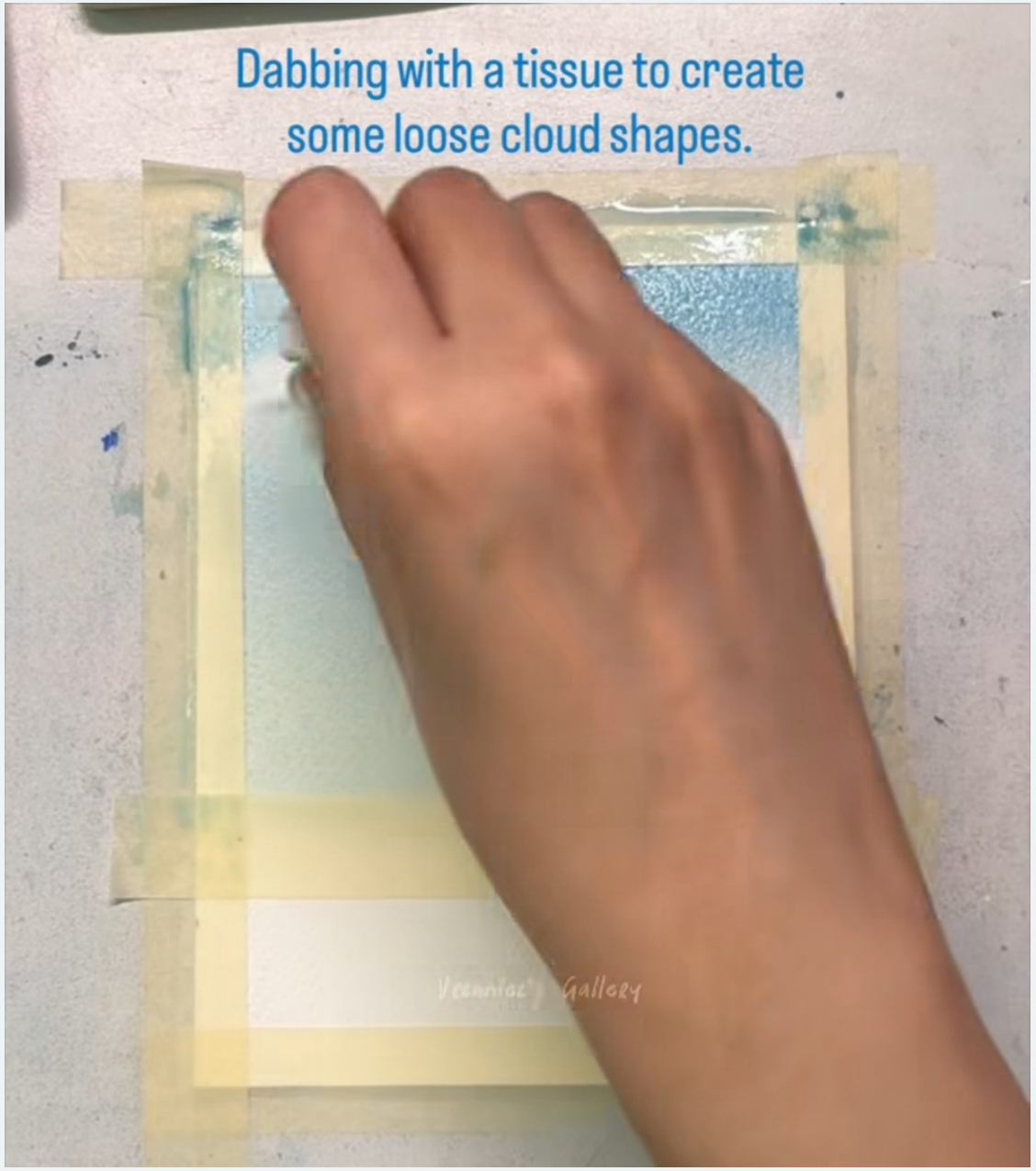
- Move your hand across the paper and dab clouds in the middle.
- Press flatter for wide clouds and with a corner for small ones.

WATCH FOR

Your hand may hide the paper while you work. Check the result after you lift.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Prussian blue
#5E95AE



STAGE 3 · CLOUDS

STEP 10 OF 60

Continue the clouds across the sky

WHAT TO DO

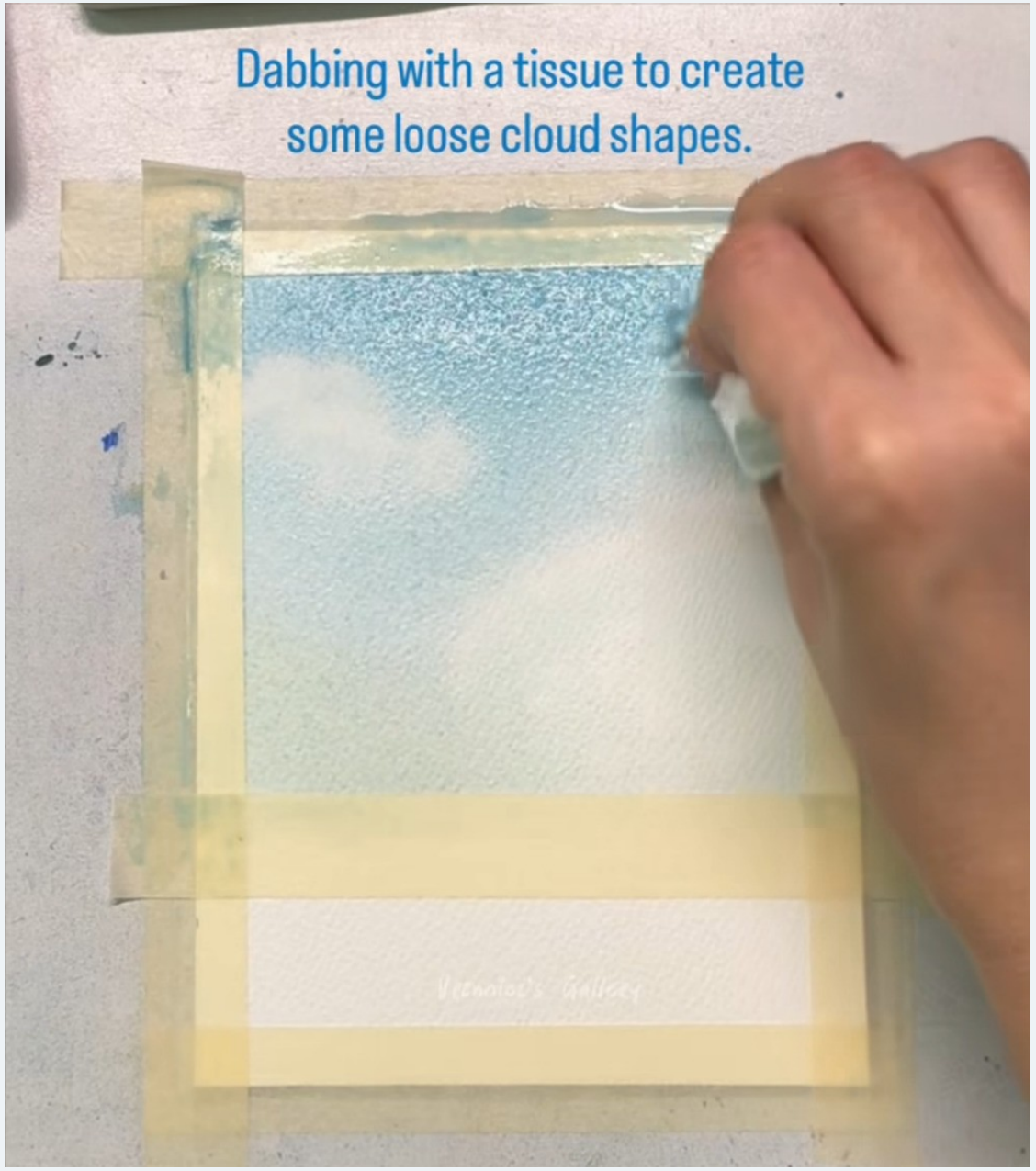
- Keep dabbing from left to right, overlapping some of the shapes.
- Switch to a clean part of the tissue as it picks up blue.

WATCH FOR

A tissue full of blue will put paint back. Use a fresh area often.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Prussian blue
#5E95AE



STAGE 3 · CLOUDS

STEP 11 OF 60

Cloud shapes start to appear

WHAT TO DO

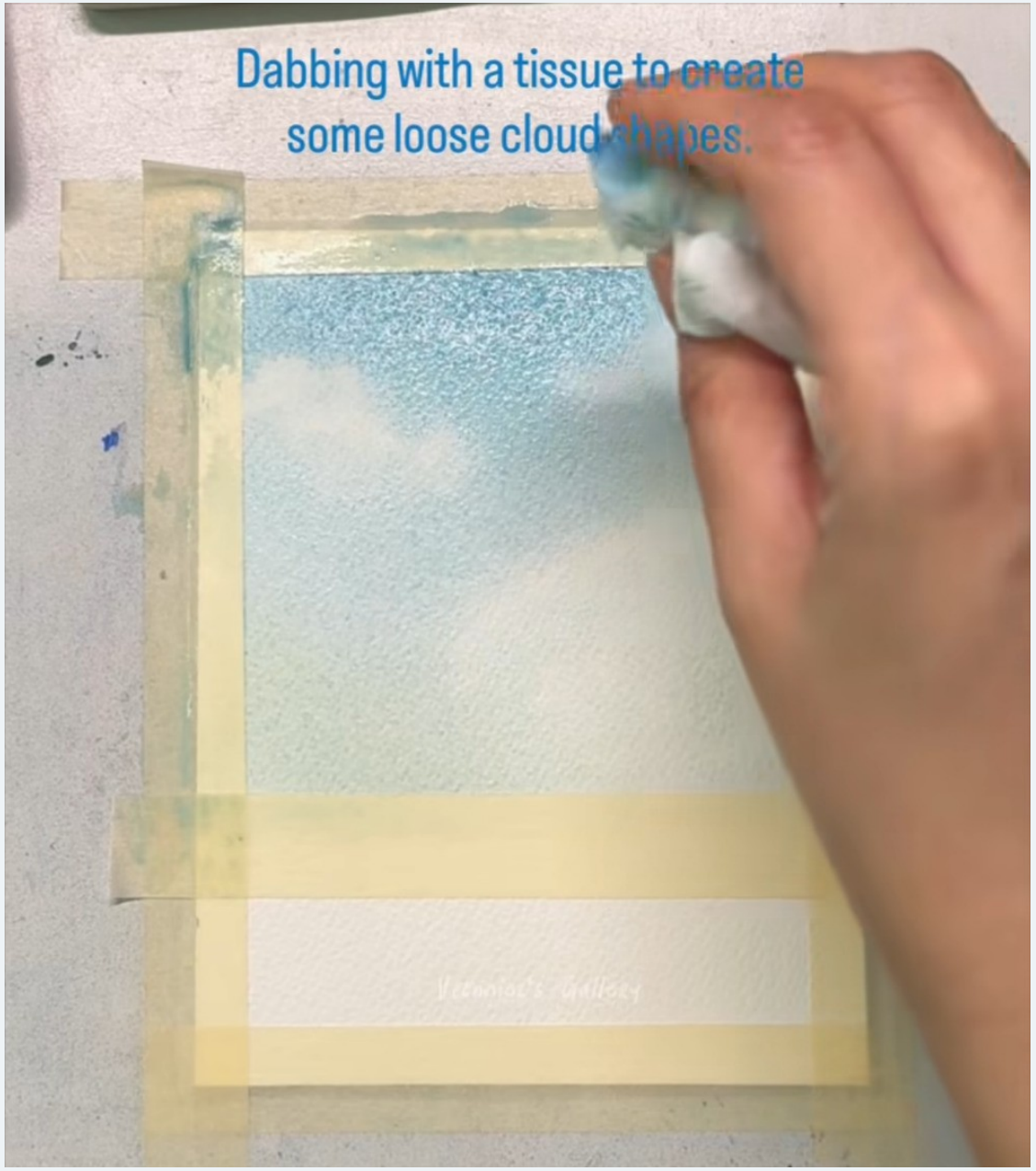
- Look for pale cloud shapes against the blue: one near the top left and a larger one at the right.
- Dab around their edges to widen them and blur the outlines.

WATCH FOR

Soft edges make the sky feel airy.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Prussian blue
#5E95AE



STAGE 3 · CLOUDS

STEP 12 OF 60

Lift paint near the top left

WHAT TO DO

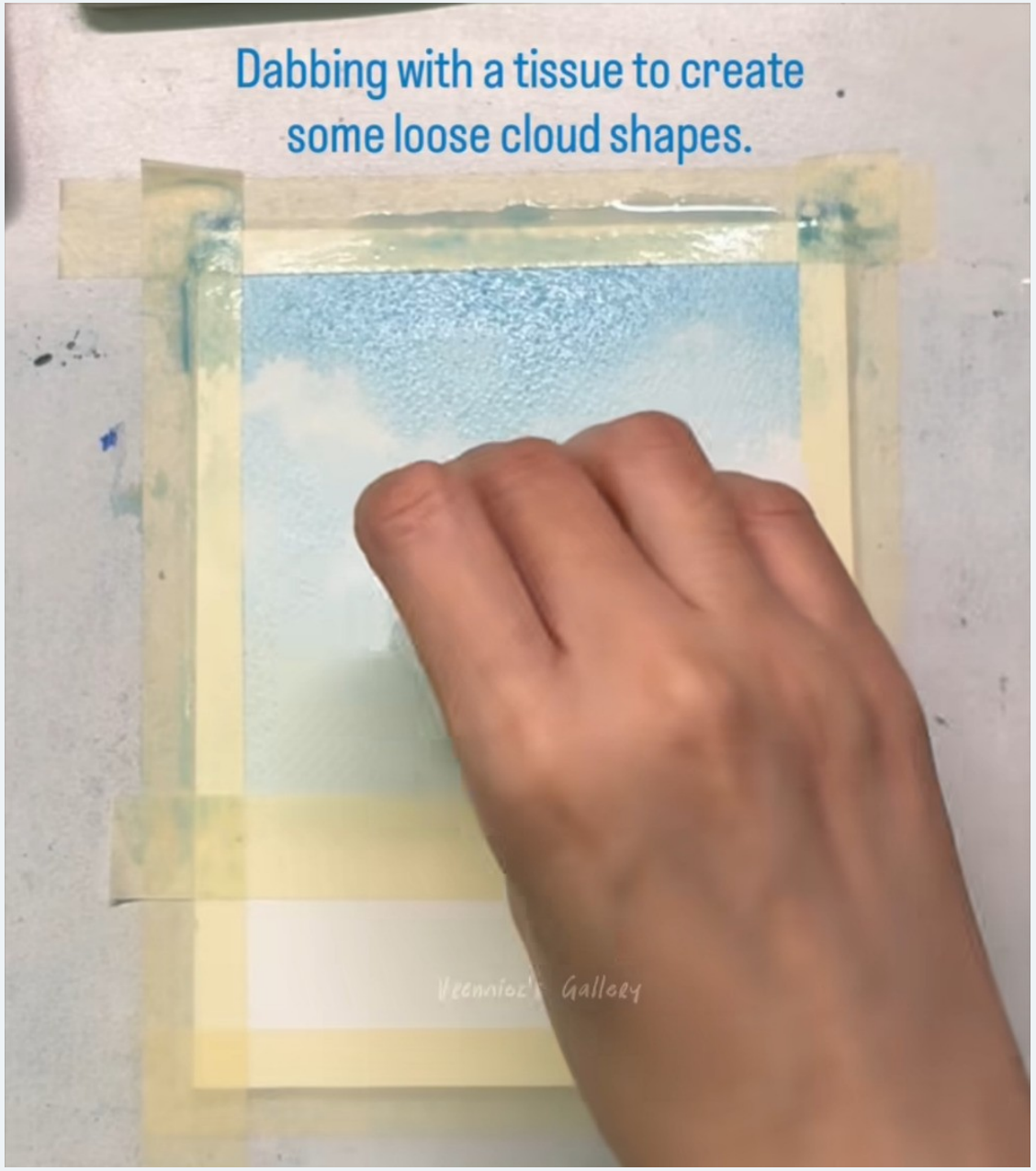
- Dab a few more cloud shapes closer to the top, where the sky is darkest.
- Keep them smaller and softer than the clouds lower down.

WATCH FOR

Hold the tissue by its edge so your fingers don't touch the wet paper.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Prussian blue
#5E95AE



STAGE 3 · CLOUDS

STEP 13 OF 60

Lift a bigger cloud lower down

WHAT TO DO

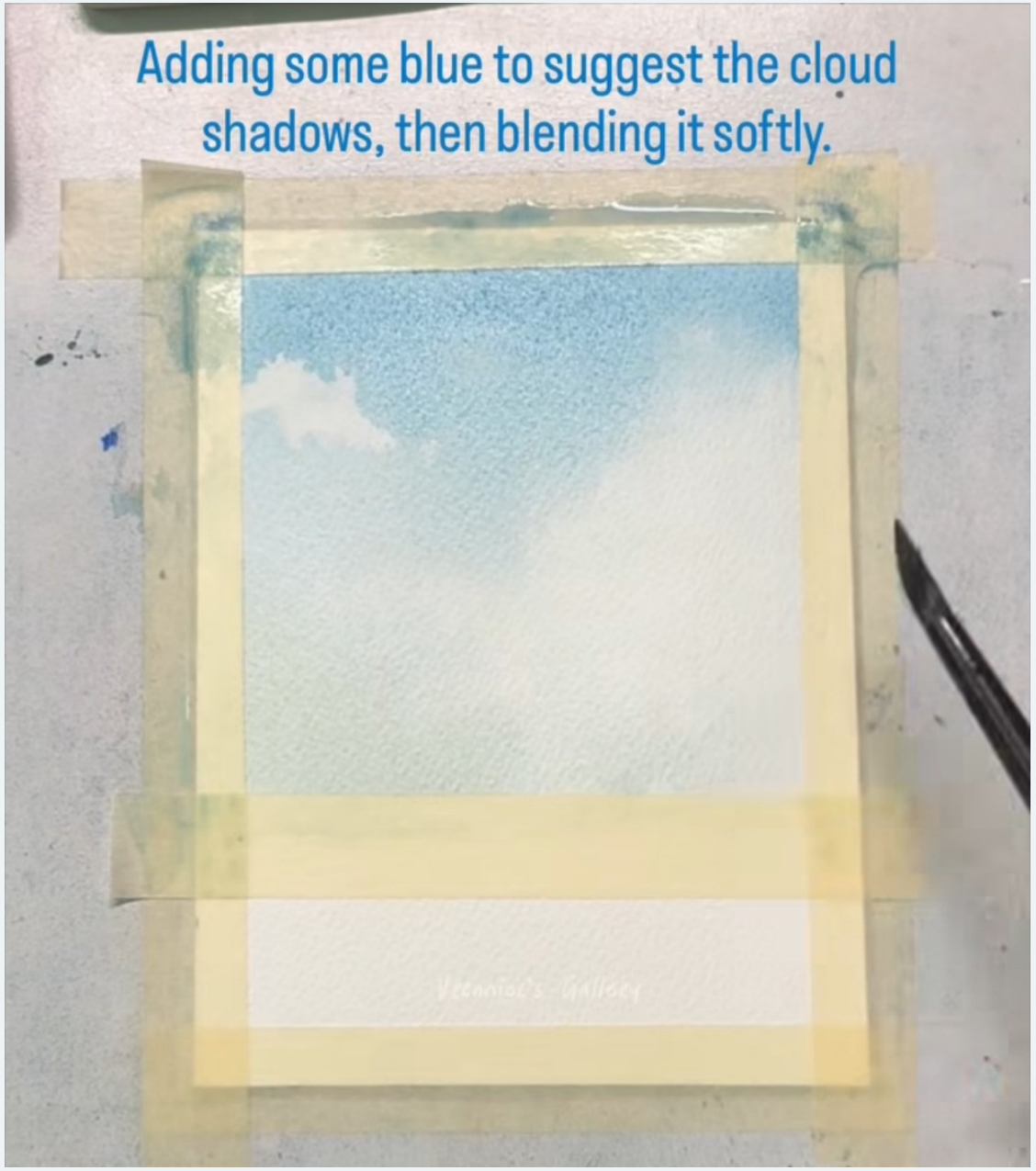
- Press the tissue flat to lift a large, soft cloud in the lower half of the sky.
- Leave the deep blue at the very top untouched.

WATCH FOR

Big, pale clouds low in the sky and small ones up high give a sense of depth.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Prussian blue
#5E95AE



STAGE 3 · CLOUDS

STEP 14 OF 60

Add blue shadows under the clouds

WHAT TO DO

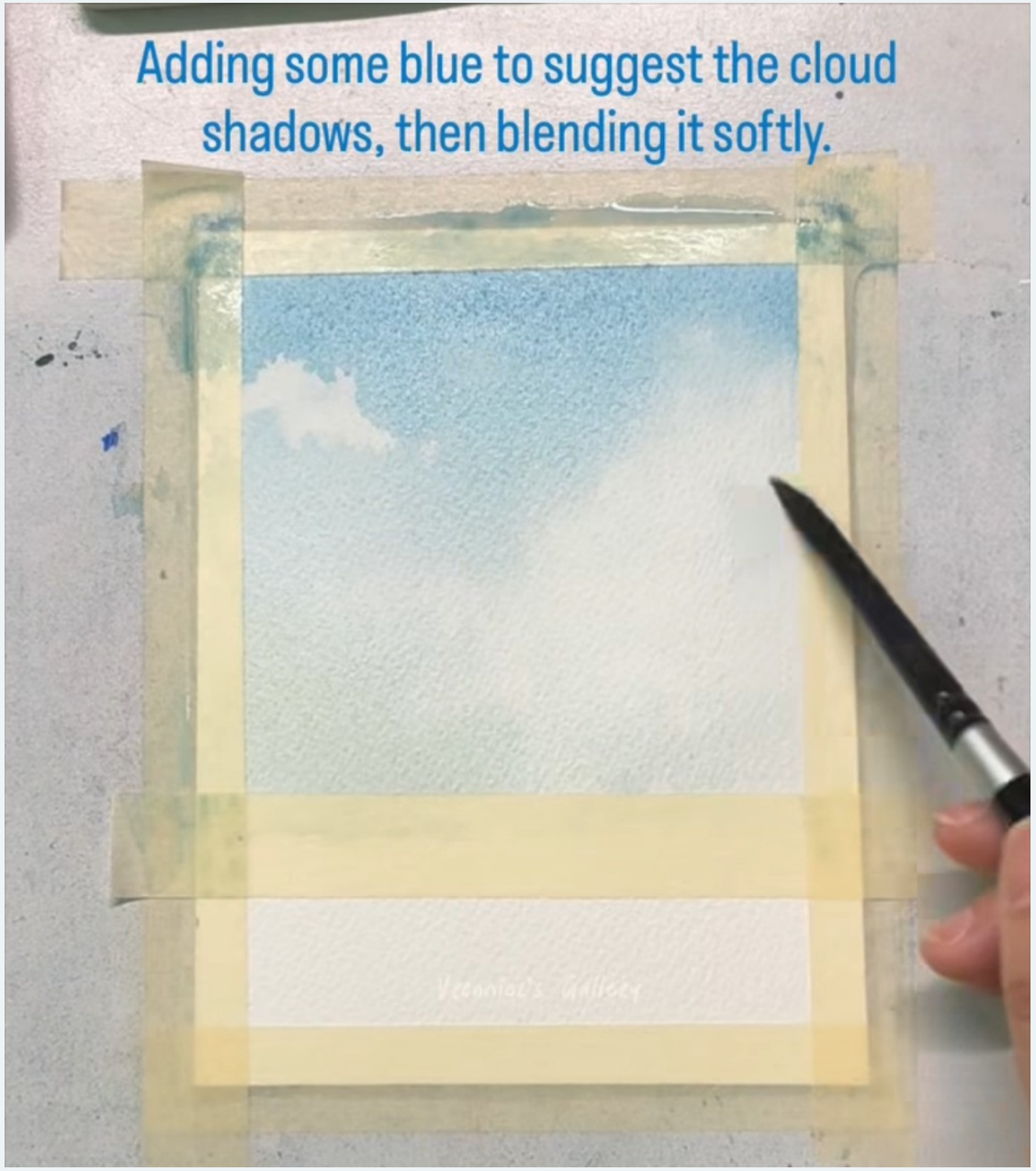
- Pick up a small amount of Prussian blue on a round brush.
- Touch it along the bottom edges of the clouds to suggest shadow.

WATCH FOR

Keep the paint thin so it only tints the underside of each cloud.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Prussian blue
#5E95AE



STAGE 3 · CLOUDS

STEP 15 OF 60

Blend the shadows softly

WHAT TO DO

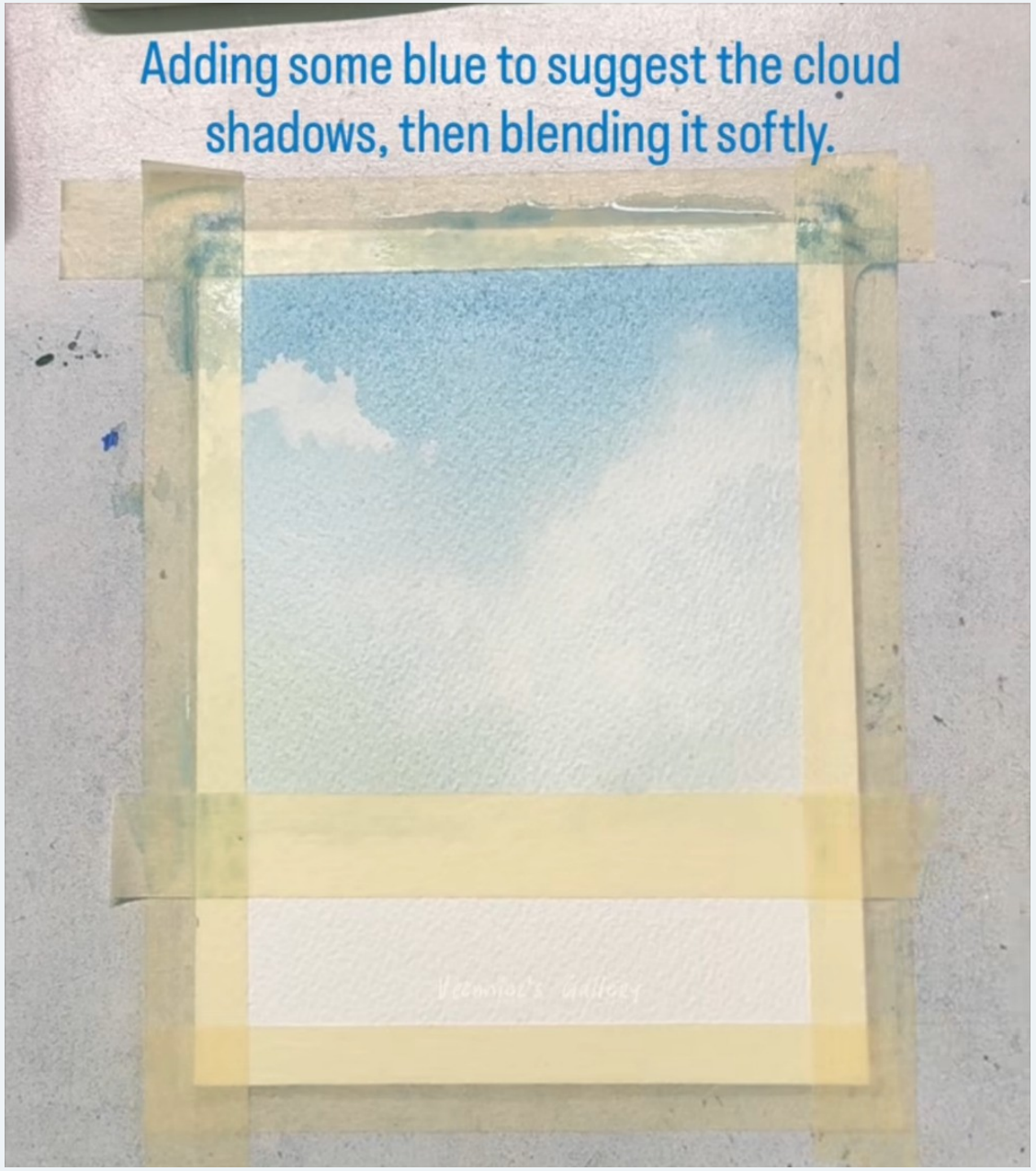
- Stroke the new blue gently into the cloud with a clean, damp brush.
- Blend until the shadow fades smoothly into the white.

WATCH FOR

No hard edges on the lower sides of the clouds.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Prussian blue
#5E95AE



STAGE 3 · CLOUDS

STEP 16 OF 60

Repeat on the remaining clouds

WHAT TO DO

- Add and blend shadows under the other clouds in the same way.
- Put every shadow on the same side so the light looks consistent.

WATCH FOR

A few soft shadows look better than many strong ones.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Prussian blue
#5E95AE



STAGE 3 · CLOUDS

Let the sky dry completely

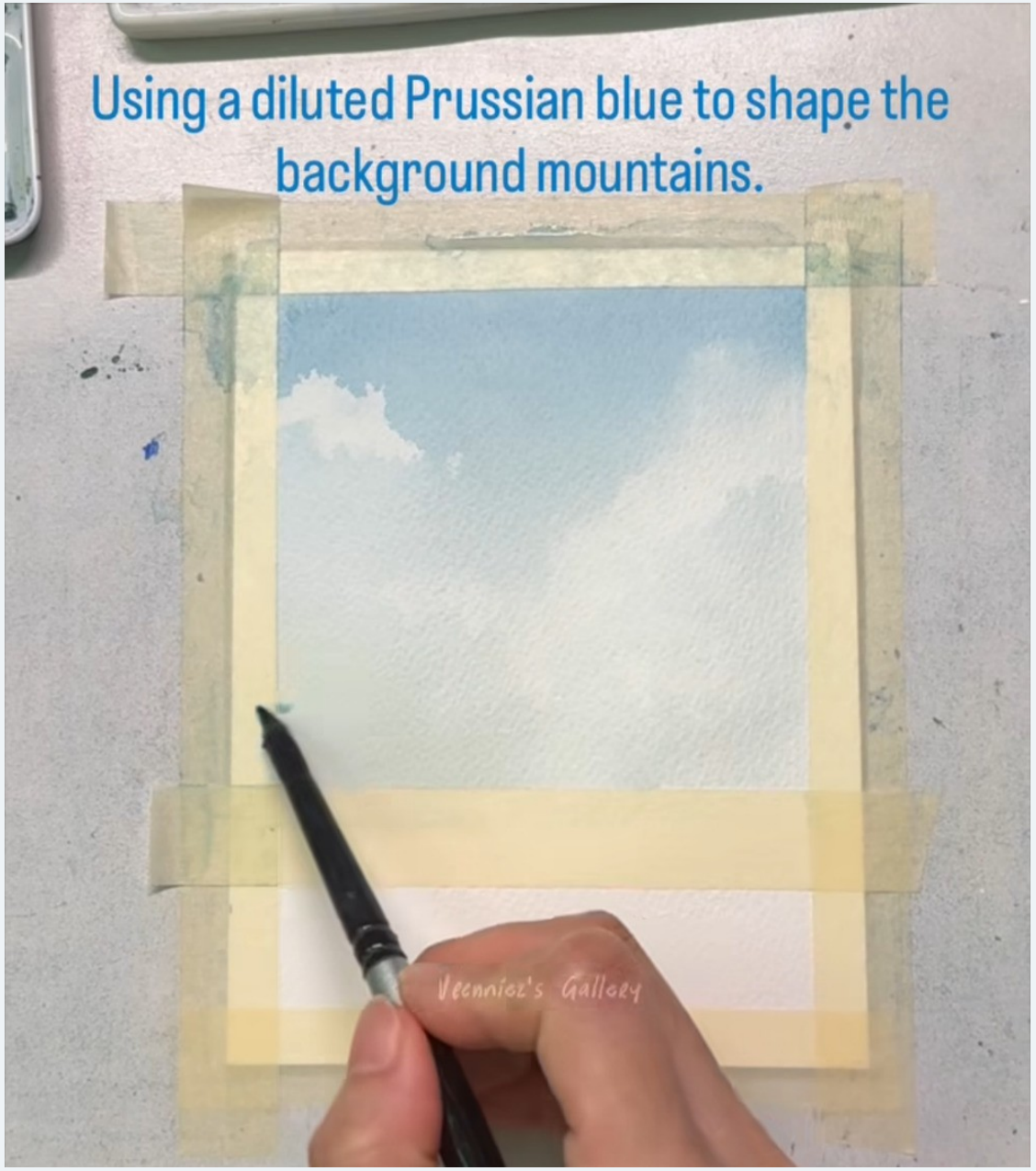
WHAT TO DO

- Put the brush down and wait until the paper has lost all its shine.
- Check that the sky is fully dry before you continue.

WATCH FOR

Painting mountains onto damp paper would blur them. Patience keeps the edges crisp.

NO PAINT IN THIS STEP: WAIT FOR IT TO DRY



STAGE 4 · FAR MOUNTAINS

STEP 18 OF 60

Mix a pale, diluted blue

WHAT TO DO

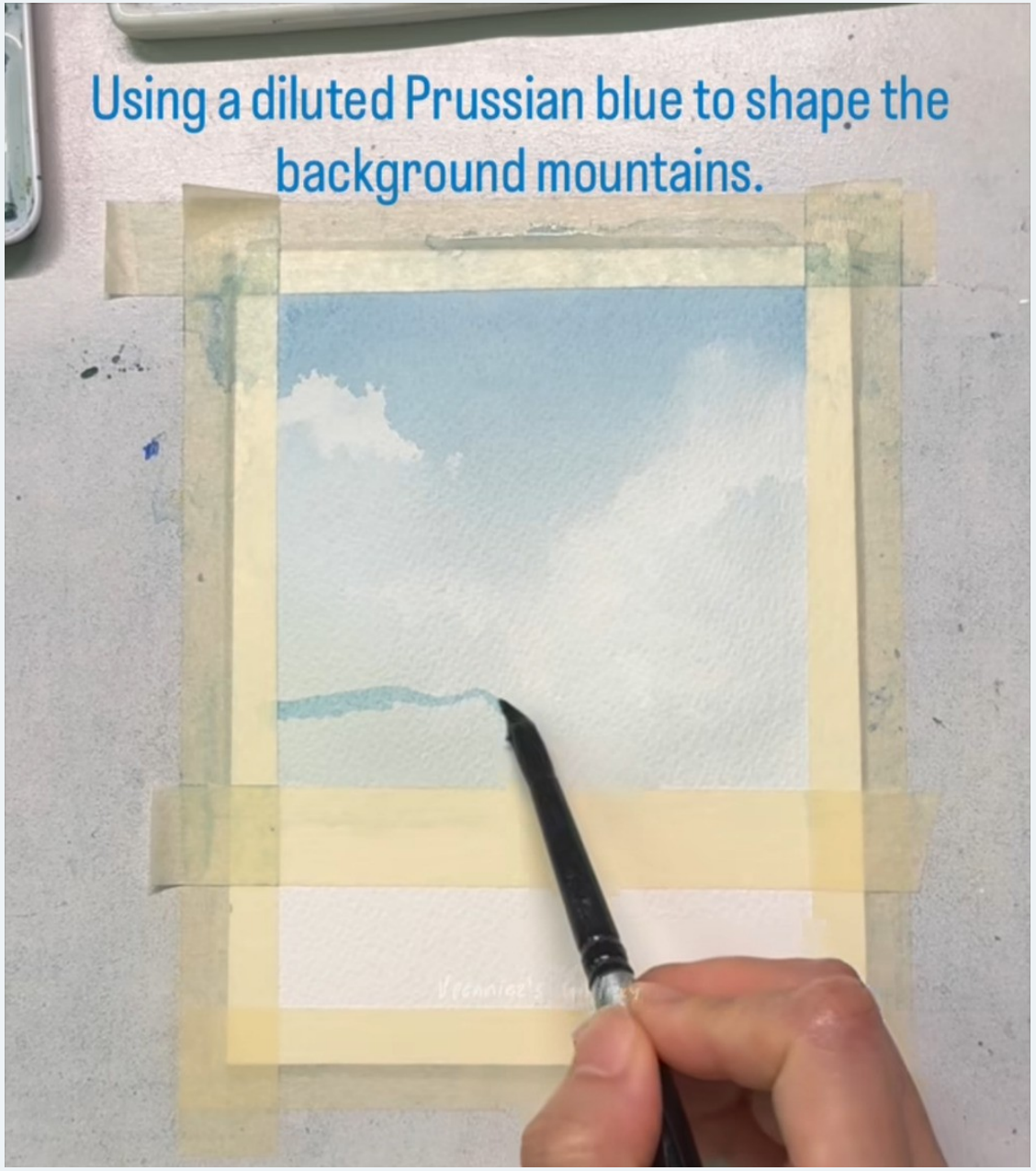
- Dilute Prussian blue with plenty of water to a pale blue-gray.
- Take a small round brush and set it at the left edge, just above the strip of tape across the paper.

WATCH FOR

The tape strip masks the sea area and gives the mountains a clean, level horizon.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Prussian blue, diluted
#BFCBC7



STAGE 4 · FAR MOUNTAINS

STEP 19 OF 60

Draw the far ridge line

WHAT TO DO

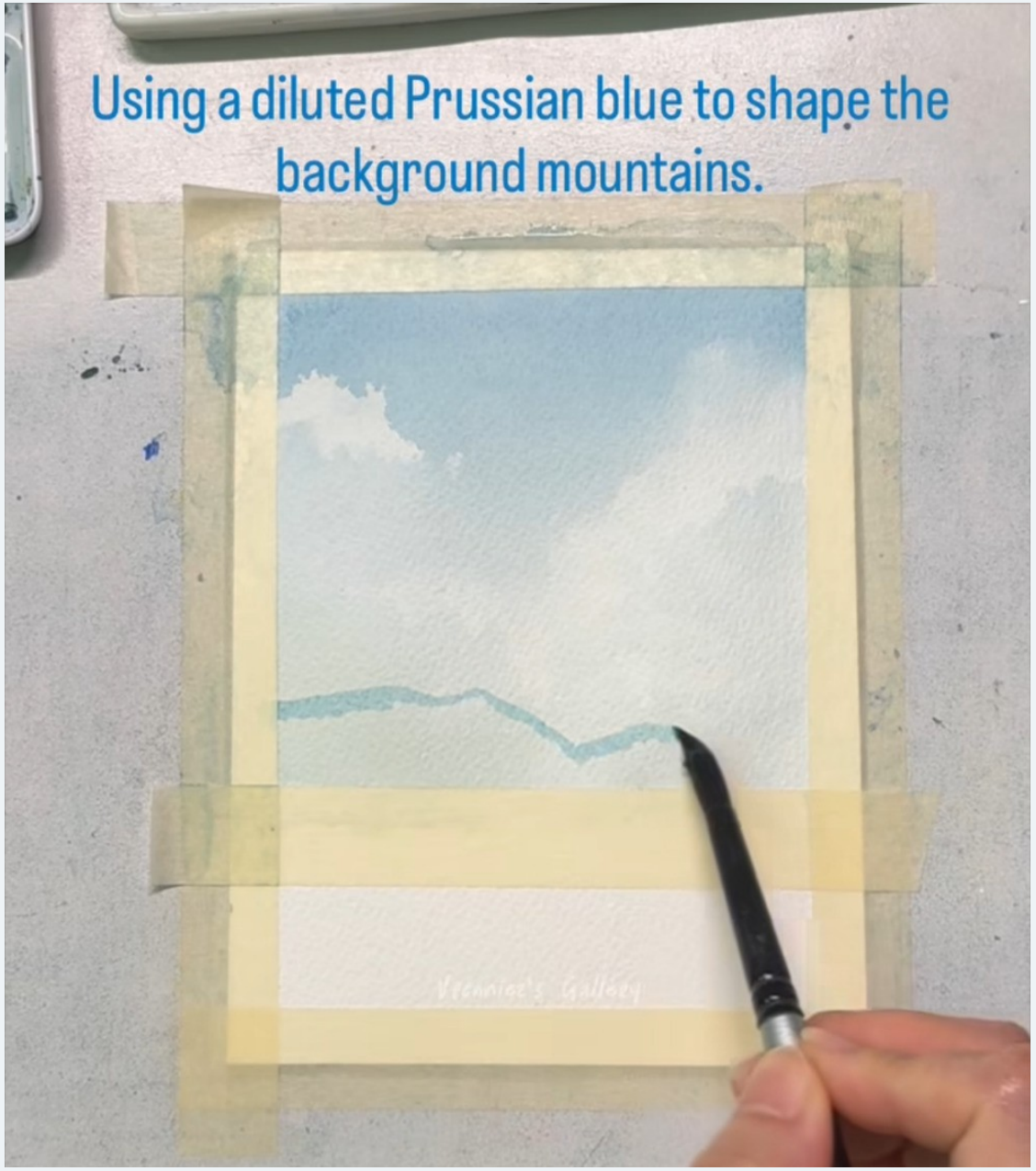
- Draw a gently wavy ridge line from the left edge with the pale blue.
- Let it rise and dip in soft peaks.

WATCH FOR

Keep it pale. Distant mountains look faint and hazy.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Prussian blue, diluted
#BFCBC7



STAGE 4 · FAR MOUNTAINS

STEP 20 OF 60

Carry the ridge to the right edge

WHAT TO DO

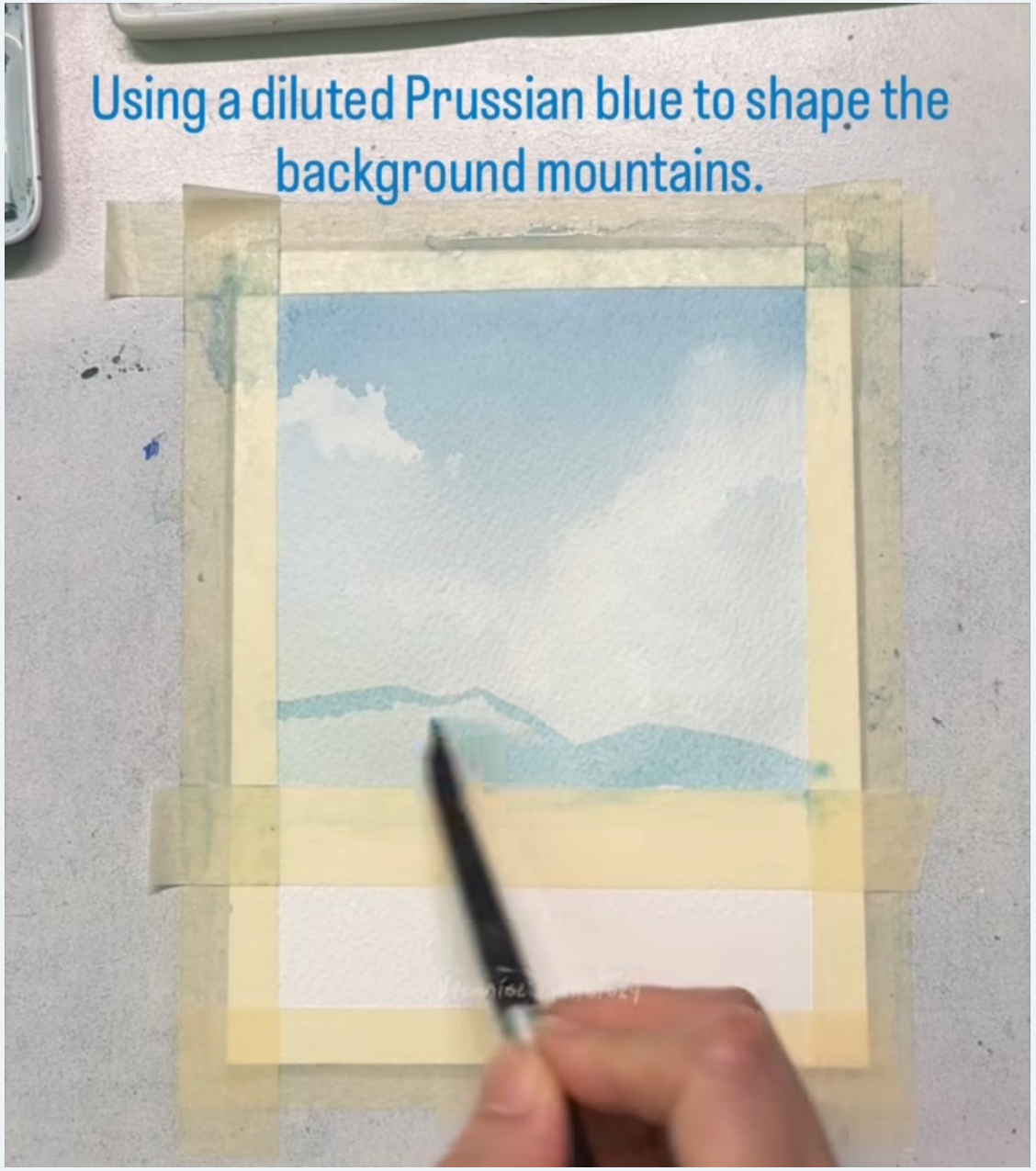
- Continue the line across the paper, adding a few broad peaks.
- Keep the shape simple: you are suggesting mountains, not drawing every rock.

WATCH FOR

Gentle slopes look farther away than sharp, spiky peaks.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Prussian blue, diluted
#BFCBC7



STAGE 4 · FAR MOUNTAINS

STEP 21 OF 60

Fill in below the ridge line

WHAT TO DO

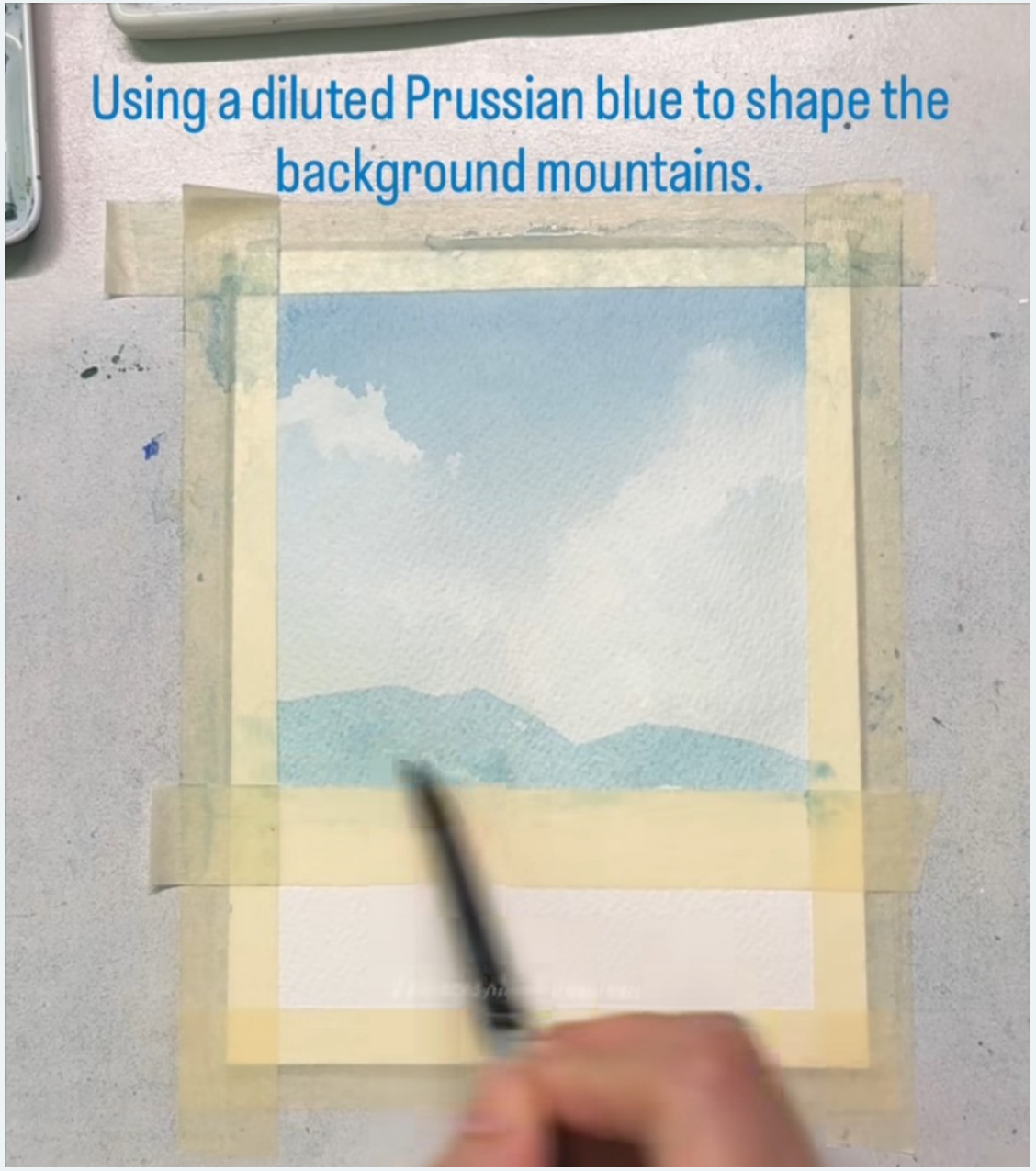
- Fill the area under the ridge with the same pale blue, down to the tape edge.
- Keep the color even and avoid heavy blotches.

WATCH FOR

Work steadily so the wash dries evenly.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Prussian blue, diluted
#BFCBC7



STAGE 4 · FAR MOUNTAINS

STEP 22 OF 60

Finish the far mountain range

WHAT TO DO

- Complete the fill so the range has two or three gentle peaks.
- Check the bottom edge sits flat against the tape.

WATCH FOR

The pale range should stay faint so the darker mountains in front will stand out.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Prussian blue, diluted
#BFCBC7



STAGE 4 · FAR MOUNTAINS

STEP 23 OF 60

Let the far mountains dry

WHAT TO DO

- Wait until the mountains are completely dry.
- They should look pale blue-gray, sitting low under the clouds.

WATCH FOR

The next layer is dark and will bleed into any damp areas.

NO PAINT IN THIS STEP: WAIT FOR IT TO DRY



STAGE 5 · NEAR MOUNTAINS

Start the dark near mountain with Payne's grey

WHAT TO DO

- Mix Payne's grey, thicker and darker than the pale blue.
- Start at the left edge, just below the pale mountains, and use the tape edge as the horizon.

WATCH FOR

Dark in front, light behind: that difference in value is what creates distance.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Payne's grey
#344556



STAGE 5 · NEAR MOUNTAINS

STEP 25 OF 60

Outline the nearest mountain

WHAT TO DO

- Trace the top edge of the near mountain with a thin, slightly wobbly line.
- Let the line slope down toward the horizon.

WATCH FOR

A little wobble looks natural. A ruler-straight edge would look fake.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Payne's grey
#344556



STAGE 5 · NEAR MOUNTAINS

STEP 26 OF 60

Fill the dark mass and run the shoreline

WHAT TO DO

- Fill the shape in solid Payne's grey.
- Then run a thin dark line along the tape edge toward the right to form the shoreline.

WATCH FOR

Rough, uneven edges at the base can read as rocks and trees.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Payne's grey
#344556



STAGE 5 · NEAR MOUNTAINS

STEP 27 OF 60

Extend the dark shoreline to the right

WHAT TO DO

- Add a smaller dark hill on the right and connect it to the left mass with the shoreline.
- Let the pale mountains show through the gap between the two dark hills.

WATCH FOR

Next the tape strip comes off. The reel cuts here, and the strip is gone by the next step.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Payne's grey
#344556



STAGE 6 · SEA

Lay in the sea with phthalo blue

WHAT TO DO

- With the tape strip removed, pick up phthalo blue (a vivid blue) and touch it to the left end of the horizon.
- Leave a thin line of bare paper between the dark mountains and the sea.

WATCH FOR

That thin white line will make the horizon sparkle. Keep your brush just below it.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Phthalo blue
#67A6CC



STAGE 6 · SEA

STEP 29 OF 60

Pull the blue across the horizon

WHAT TO DO

- Drag the blue in one steady stroke from left to right.
- Keep the stroke straight and level.

WATCH FOR

A level horizon matters. Slanting it will make the sea look like it is tipping.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Phthalo blue
#67A6CC



STAGE 6 · SEA

STEP 30 OF 60

Work downward, leaving white wave flecks

WHAT TO DO

- Brush lighter blue below the horizon band, pressing very lightly.
- Let the brush skip over the paper's grain so small white flecks stay unpainted.

WATCH FOR

Light pressure skips across the texture of the paper. Those flecks become little waves.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Phthalo blue
#67A6CC



STAGE 6 · SEA

STEP 31 OF 60

Add more broken wave flecks

WHAT TO DO

- Keep working down the sea with light, horizontal strokes.
- Leave more gaps toward the bottom, where waves are closer to us.

WATCH FOR

Bigger, brighter flecks in front and smaller ones near the horizon look natural.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Phthalo blue
#67A6CC



STAGE 6 · SEA

STEP 32 OF 60

Add a second soft layer of blue

WHAT TO DO

- Brush a slightly deeper blue in horizontal bands, strongest near the horizon.
- Let each band fade as it comes toward you.

WATCH FOR

Keep the strokes horizontal: that keeps the water looking flat and calm.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Phthalo blue
#67A6CC



STAGE 6 · SEA

STEP 33 OF 60

Shape the light and shadow in the water

WHAT TO DO

- Keep laying darker bands next to lighter ones across the sea.
- Leave the white flecks showing between them.

WATCH FOR

Look for the contrast between deeper bands and bright flecks: that is the sparkle of water.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Phthalo blue
#67A6CC



STAGE 7 · BEACH

STEP 34 OF 60

Start the beach at the bottom left

WHAT TO DO

- Load a brush with raw sienna, a warm golden tan.
- Stroke it along the bottom of the painting, starting at the left.

WATCH FOR

Warm sand against cool blue water makes the shoreline pop.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Raw sienna
#D7B47C



STAGE 7 · BEACH

STEP 35 OF 60

Extend the sand stripe across

WHAT TO DO

- Carry the raw sienna across to the right in a steady stroke.
- Keep the top edge of the stripe slightly uneven, like a shoreline.

WATCH FOR

Don't paint the shoreline as a hard, straight line.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Raw sienna
#D7B47C



STAGE 7 · BEACH

STEP 36 OF 60

Widen the sand band

WHAT TO DO

- Add a second stroke above the first to make the sand band deeper.
- Let the strokes overlap slightly.

WATCH FOR

Overlapping strokes give the sand a natural, uneven look.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Raw sienna
#D7B47C



STAGE 7 · BEACH

STEP 37 OF 60

Keep building the sand

WHAT TO DO

- Continue to fill the lower part of the painting with raw sienna.
- Use more water as you move upward so the color gets paler.

WATCH FOR

The sand is deepest at the bottom and fades toward the water.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Raw sienna
#D7B47C



STAGE 7 · BEACH

STEP 38 OF 60

Soften where sand meets sea

WHAT TO DO

- Use a damp brush to blend the top edge of the sand into the blue.
- Keep the blend small. A little overlap is enough.

WATCH FOR

Too much blending can turn the meeting point muddy green. Stop early.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Raw sienna
#D7B47C

Phthalo blue
#67A6CC



STAGE 7 · BEACH

STEP 39 OF 60

Lighten the sand toward the water

WHAT TO DO

- Thin the raw sienna with water and brush upward so the sand fades toward the sea.
- Keep the stroke direction consistent.

WATCH FOR

Pale sand near the waterline reads as wet sand catching the light.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Raw sienna
#D7B47C



STAGE 7 · BEACH

STEP 40 OF 60

Even out the beach

WHAT TO DO

- Step back and look: the sand should be a smooth, golden band across the bottom.
- Touch up any streaks with a slightly damp brush.

WATCH FOR

Fix only what bothers you. Overworking watercolor often does more harm than good.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Raw sienna
#D7B47C



STAGE 8 · DEEPEN THE COLOR

Decide whether to deepen the color

WHAT TO DO

- Look at the sea and sand. If they look too pale, plan one more thin layer.
- The artist jokes in the caption that this layer probably wasn't needed.

WATCH FOR

A second layer works best over paint that has already dried.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

- **Phthalo blue** #67A6CC
- **Raw sienna** #D7B47C



STAGE 8 · DEEPEN THE COLOR

STEP 42 OF 60

Add a deeper blue at the left of the sea

WHAT TO DO

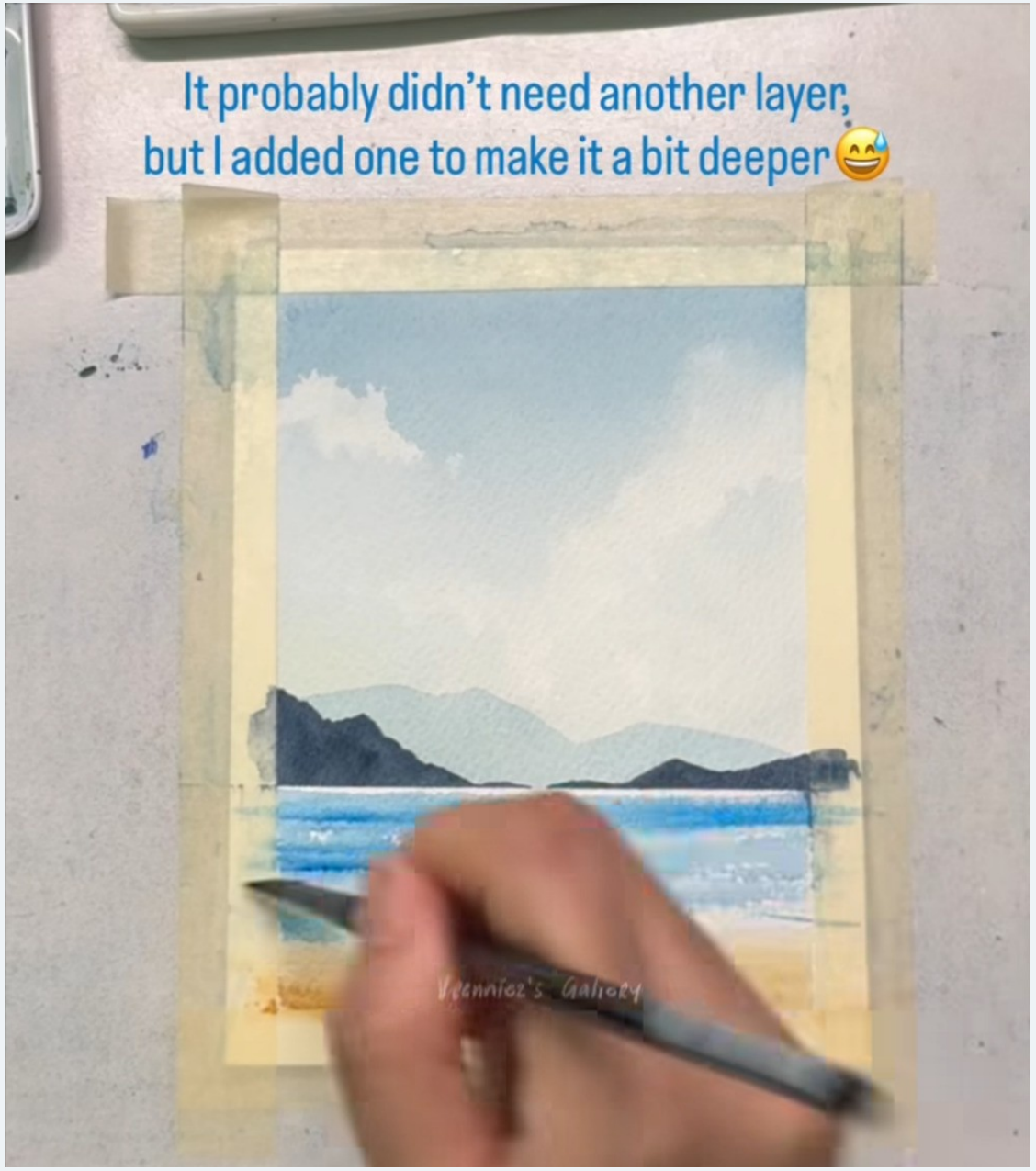
- Take a thin brush with phthalo blue and glaze a darker band along the left of the horizon.
- Keep the stroke thin and even.

WATCH FOR

A glaze is a transparent layer, so the white flecks underneath can still show.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Phthalo blue
#67A6CC



STAGE 8 · DEEPEN THE COLOR

STEP 43 OF 60

Carry the deeper blue across the water

WHAT TO DO

- Continue the glaze toward the right in horizontal strokes.
- Skip over the brightest wave flecks.

WATCH FOR

You don't need to cover everything. Leave some of the first layer showing.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Phthalo blue
#67A6CC



STAGE 8 · DEEPEN THE COLOR

STEP 44 OF 60

Keep layering across the middle

WHAT TO DO

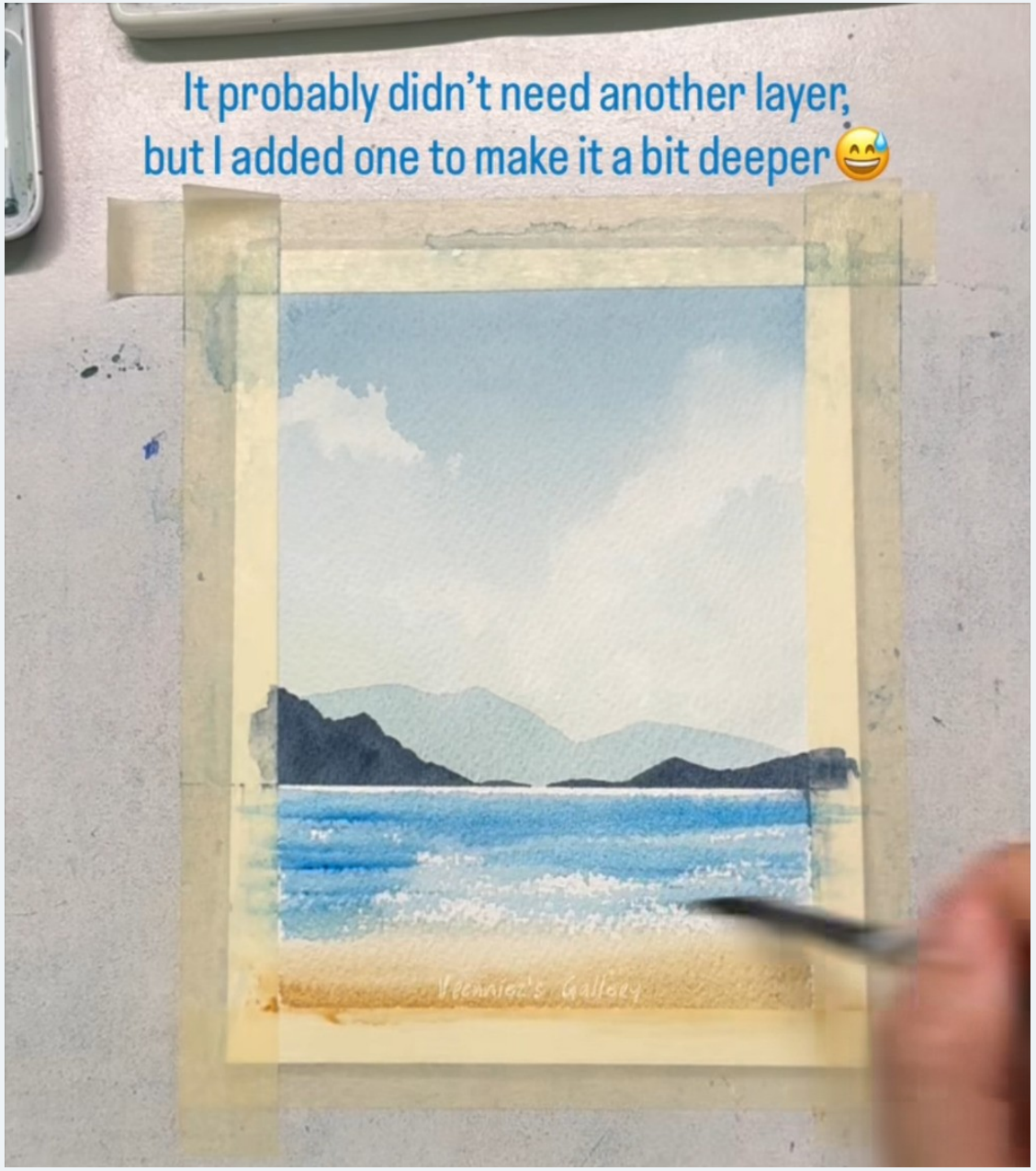
- Work across the middle of the sea, again in horizontal strokes.
- Let the glaze overlap the edges of the first layer.

WATCH FOR

Your hand may hide the water here. Check the result when you lift it.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Phthalo blue
#67A6CC



STAGE 8 · DEEPEN THE COLOR

STEP 45 OF 60

Check the deeper sea

WHAT TO DO

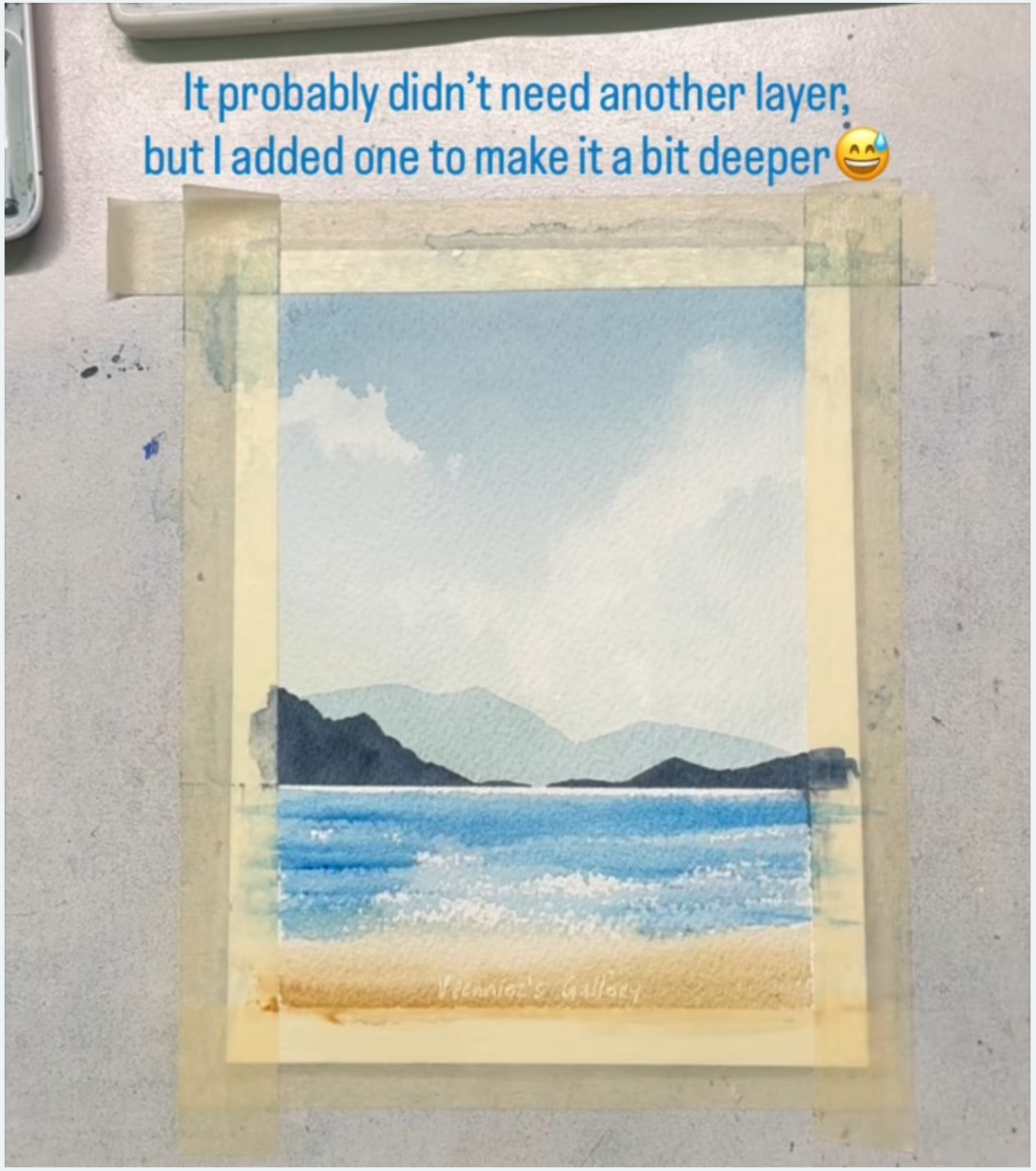
- Look at the sea: it should now be a richer blue, with bright wave flecks still visible.
- Stop adding color if it already looks right.

WATCH FOR

More layers are not always better. It is easy to lose the white flecks.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Phthalo blue
#67A6CC



STAGE 8 · DEEPEN THE COLOR

STEP 46 OF 60

Judge the balance of light and dark

WHAT TO DO

- Compare the sea with the sky and the mountains.
- The darkest darks should be the near mountains, with the sea a step lighter.

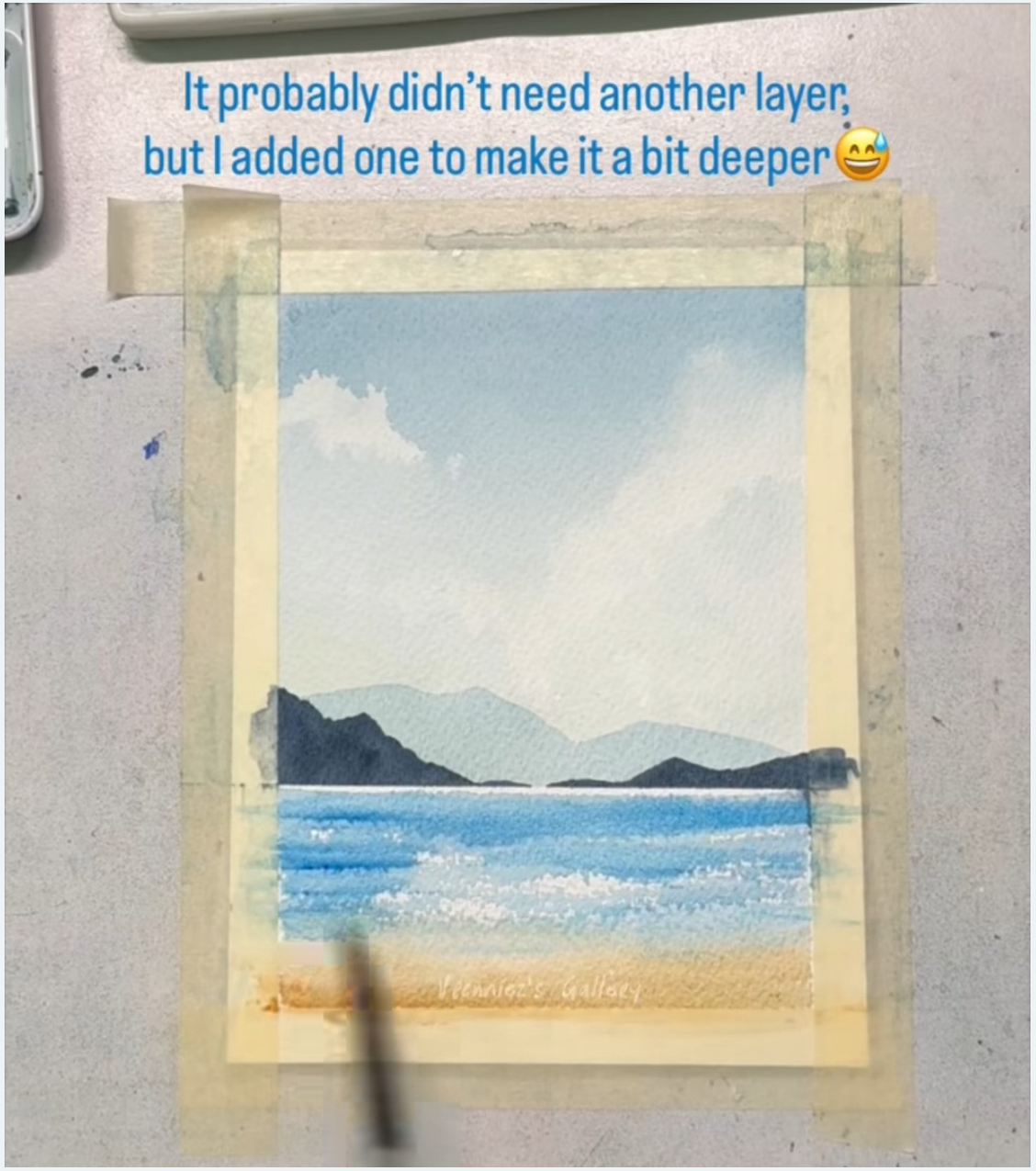
WATCH FOR

If the sea is darker than the near mountains, the picture can look top-heavy.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Phthalo blue
#67A6CC

Payne's grey
#344556



STAGE 8 · DEEPEN THE COLOR

STEP 47 OF 60

Small touch-ups near the shore

WHAT TO DO

- Use a thin brush to tidy any rough spots where the sea meets the sand.
- Add a hint of deeper blue just above the waterline if needed.

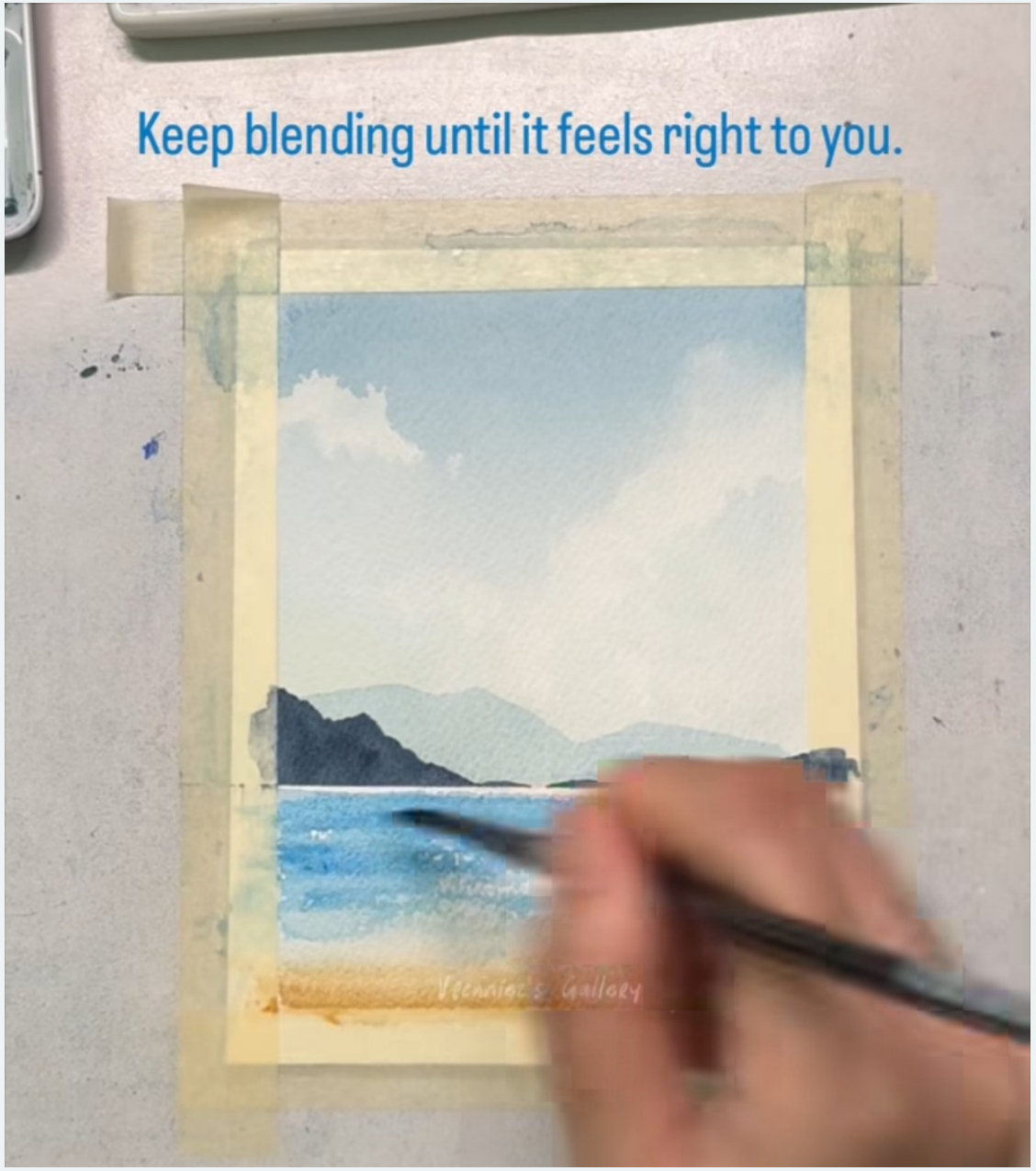
WATCH FOR

Small touches only. The big shapes are already in place.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Phthalo blue
#67A6CC

Raw sienna
#D7B47C



STAGE 9 · BLEND

Blend the sea edges

WHAT TO DO

- Use a damp brush to soften any hard edges in the water.
- Work gently with short strokes.

WATCH FOR

The caption says to keep blending until it feels right to you. Trust your eye.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Phthalo blue
#67A6CC



STAGE 9 · BLEND

STEP 49 OF 60

Soften where sand meets water

WHAT TO DO

- Blend the lower edge of the sea into the sand a little more.
- Keep a soft, wavy edge rather than a ruled line.

WATCH FOR

A soft shoreline looks natural. A hard line looks painted on.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Phthalo blue
#67A6CC

Raw sienna
#D7B47C



STAGE 9 · BLEND

Stop when it feels right

WHAT TO DO

- Look at the whole painting: sea smoother, beach slightly deeper at the bottom edge.
- Let everything dry before you add the finishing details.

WATCH FOR

Knowing when to stop is a skill. Put the brush down once the color feels balanced.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Phthalo blue
#67A6CC

Raw sienna
#D7B47C



STAGE 10 · BIRDS

STEP 51 OF 60

Switch to a fine black pen

WHAT TO DO

- Pick up a fine-tip black pen. The one in the reel is labeled Micron 05.
- Hover it over the sky, deciding where the first bird should go.

WATCH FOR

Waterproof ink won't smear over dry paint. Make sure the sky is dry first.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Black fine-tip pen
#314343



STAGE 10 · BIRDS

Draw the first bird

WHAT TO DO

- Draw a tiny bird as two quick, curved strokes that meet in a small “v”.
- Place it in the upper right of the sky.

WATCH FOR

Birds are just two small curves. Don't add detail.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Black fine-tip pen
#314343



STAGE 10 · BIRDS

Add a few more small birds

WHAT TO DO

- Add several more birds nearby, each at a slightly different angle.
- Keep them small and loosely grouped.

WATCH FOR

A loose cluster looks like a flock. Even spacing looks like wallpaper.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Black fine-tip pen
#314343



STAGE 10 · BIRDS

Vary the birds' size

WHAT TO DO

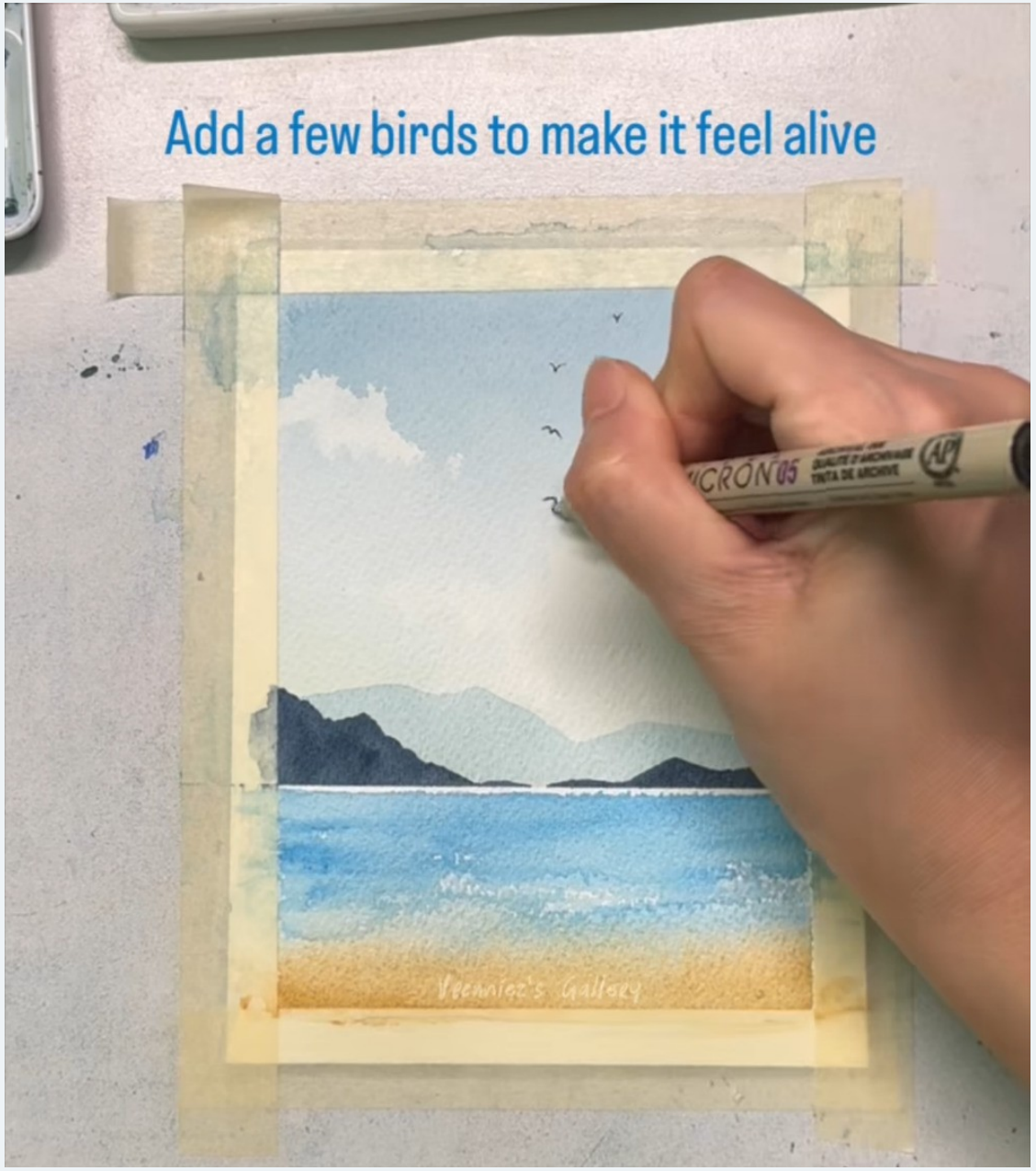
- Make some birds slightly bigger and some smaller.
- Tilt the wings differently so they look like they are in motion.

WATCH FOR

Smaller birds look farther away, bigger ones look closer.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Black fine-tip pen
#314343



STAGE 10 · BIRDS

Spread the flock

WHAT TO DO

- Add a few birds a little farther from the group.
- Aim to guide the eye from the flock toward the mountains.

WATCH FOR

Stray birds make the flock feel natural.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Black fine-tip pen
#314343



STAGE 10 · BIRDS

Place a few birds higher in the sky

WHAT TO DO

- Add one or two birds near the top of the sky.
- Keep them very small.

WATCH FOR

Don't overdo it. Eight to twelve birds is plenty.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Black fine-tip pen
#314343



STAGE 10 · BIRDS

STEP 57 OF 60

A last bird or two

WHAT TO DO

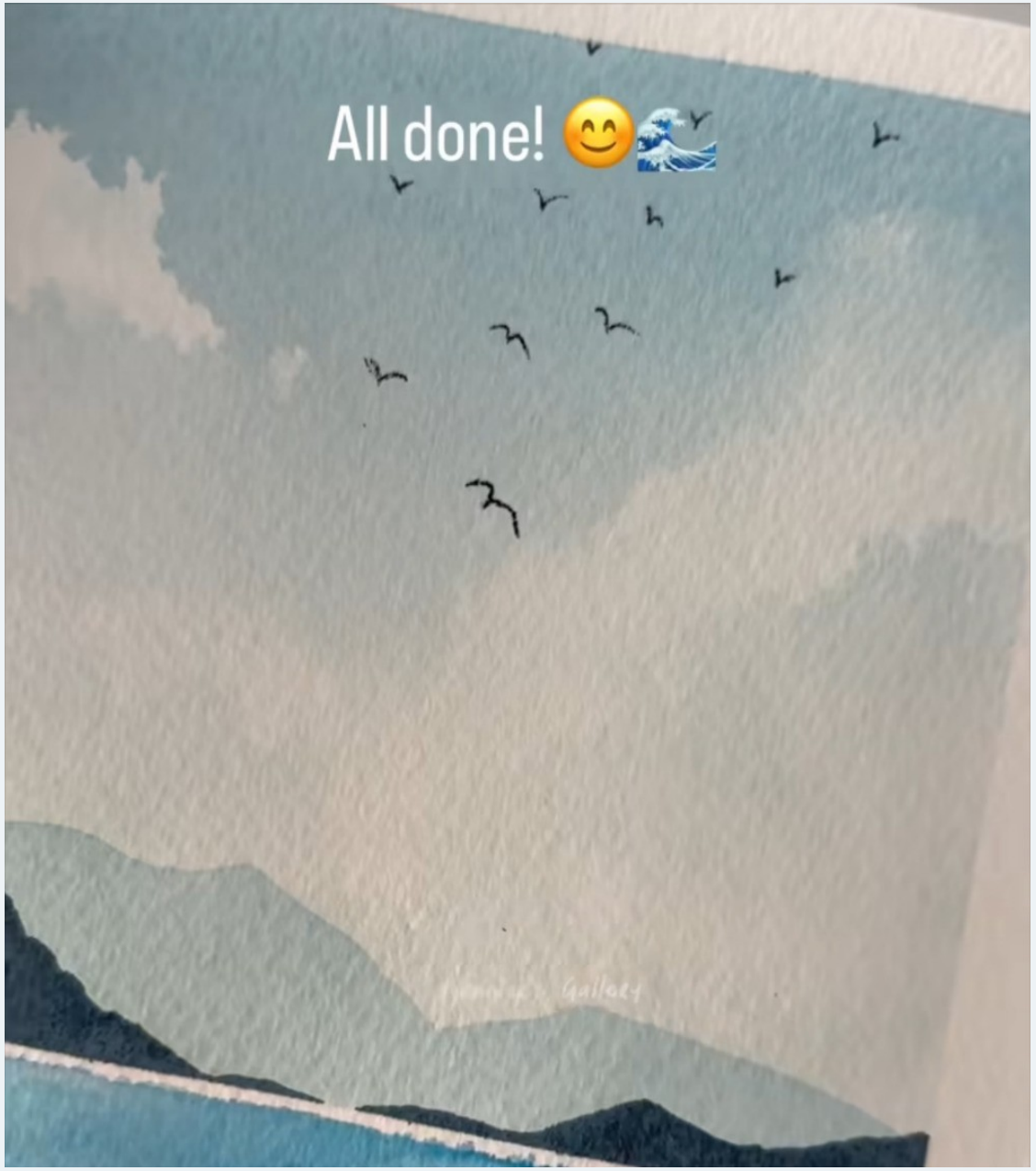
- Add one final bird on the left to balance the flock on the right.
- Lift the pen and look before you add another.

WATCH FOR

Stop while the sky still has plenty of open space.

COLORS IN THIS STEP

Black fine-tip pen
#314343



STAGE 11 · FINISHED PAINTING

STEP 58 OF 60

Close-up on the finished sky and sea

WHAT TO DO

- The reel zooms in to show the finished details: soft clouds, pale mountains and a white horizon line.
- Notice the small birds and the layered tones of blue.

WATCH FOR

Zoom in on your own painting like this to judge it. Details show up that you miss at arm's length.

FULL PALETTE ON SLIDE 5



STAGE 11 · FINISHED PAINTING

Peel the tape and reveal the painting

WHAT TO DO

- Once everything is fully dry, peel the tape away slowly, pulling it back over itself and away from the paint.
- A clean white border is left around the picture. The artist also signs and dates the corner.

WATCH FOR

Peeling slowly keeps the paper from tearing. This is a general tip; the reel shows only the result.

FULL PALETTE ON SLIDE 5



STAGE 11 · FINISHED PAINTING

STEP 60 OF 60

The finished seascape

WHAT TO DO

- Is the sky pale at the horizon and deepest at the top?
- Are the near mountains the darkest shapes, with the horizon kept level?
- Does the sea sparkle with white flecks, and the sand glow warm?

WATCH FOR

Use this view as your reference when you check your own painting.

FULL PALETTE ON SLIDE 5

Tips for your first seascape

1 Practice the tissue lift

Wet a scrap of paper with blue and practice lifting clouds. Timing matters: the paint has to still be wet.

2 Wait when it says wait

The artist writes “Let it dry..” twice. Both times it protects crisp edges for the next layer.

3 Keep your brush light

Light pressure skips across the paper's grain and leaves the white flecks that read as waves.

4 Keep the horizon level

A tilted horizon makes the whole sea look like it is sliding. Check it with the tape edge as your guide.

5 Don't over-layer

The artist admits the extra layer “probably wasn't needed.” Stop when the painting looks balanced.

6 Aim for the feel, not a copy

Your clouds, waves and birds will not match the reel exactly, and they don't need to.

Tips draw on the reel's captions plus general watercolor practice.